

Julius Caesar

William Shakespeare · 1599

First Folio (1623) text as edited by Standard Ebooks

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

19 scene lessons plus 2 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 24 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 5 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC
Cover: J. M. W. Turner, The Fighting Temeraire (1839). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).

Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–19), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Whole-book test and answer key
6. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Julius Caesar survives only in the 1623 First Folio; it was first performed in 1599 at the new Globe. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks edition, divided into the conventional 18 scenes (plus the cast list). Shakespeare's main source was Thomas North's 1579 English translation of Plutarch's Lives. Cite act, scene and line from this edition.

Content note for teachers: Political assassination on stage, mob violence, battle deaths and three suicides (one reported); Roman ideas of honorable suicide need careful, critical discussion. See the scene notes and the safe-messaging script.

Grades: Grades 9–10 (also 8 with support; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Excerpt-based support track: these plays are above the grades 6–8 text-complexity band, so Middle School prompts work from teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 5. **Class days:** 24 × 90 minutes (19 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Julius Caesar suggest about power, ambition and tyranny?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about honor and self-deception?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about rhetoric and persuasion?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about public versus private self?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about fate, omens and free will?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the play.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards: Common Core

RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Dramatis Personae Act I, Scene I Act I, Scene II Act I, Scene III	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*power, ambition and tyranny* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Act II, Scene I *Socratic seminar on power, ambition and tyranny* Act II, Scene II Act II, Scene III Act II, Scene IV	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*honor and self-deception* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on power, ambition and tyranny • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Act III, Scene I Act III, Scene II Act III, Scene III Act IV, Scene I Act IV, Scene II	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*rhetoric and persuasion* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
4	Act IV, Scene III Act V, Scene I *Socratic seminar on honor and self-deception* Act V, Scene II Act V, Scene III	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*public versus private self* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on honor and self-deception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
5	Act V, Scene IV Act V, Scene V *Whole-book test (90 minutes)*	4 × 90 min (360 min)	*fate, omens and free will* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket,	Whole-book test and final essay

	Final essay workshop and submission		closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final essay workshop and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Julius Caesar

Author biography

William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, married Anne Hathaway in 1582 and had three children, Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith. By the early 1590s he was writing and acting in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, the company that built the Globe on the south bank of the Thames in 1599. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays, including histories of English kings and tragedies drawn from Roman history, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. His fellow actors collected his plays in the First Folio of 1623.

Historical and cultural context

Julius Caesar dates from 1599, the year the Globe opened; a Swiss traveller, Thomas Platter, recorded seeing a play about Caesar at a Thameside playhouse on 21 September 1599. Shakespeare's source was Plutarch's Lives of the Noble Grecians and Romans in Thomas North's English translation (1579), which he followed closely, sometimes almost word for word. The historical Caesar was stabbed in the Senate house on the Ides of March (15 March) 44 BCE by senators led by Brutus and Cassius; Antony and Octavius defeated them at Philippi in 42 BCE. For English audiences in 1599 the story had urgent echoes: Queen Elizabeth I was old, had no heir, and the question of who would rule next, and whether resisting a ruler could ever be justified, was dangerous to discuss openly.

Publication and reception, then and now

The play was first printed in the First Folio (1623), in an unusually clean text that is thought to come from a theatrical manuscript. It is the first of Shakespeare's Roman tragedies, followed by Antony and Cleopatra and Coriolanus.

Then: It was popular from the start: the poet Leonard Digges, in verses printed in 1640, recalled audiences "ravish'd" by the quarrel scene between Brutus and Cassius while other plays emptied the house. It remained in the repertory after the Restoration and was among the most performed Shakespeare plays in the eighteenth century.

Now: The play is a school standard, partly because it has little sexual content and centres on rhetoric and politics. Productions often make it about modern power: Orson Welles's 1937 Mercury Theatre staging dressed Caesar as a fascist dictator; Joseph Mankiewicz's 1953 film starred Marlon Brando as Antony; the Public Theater's 2017 Shakespeare in the Park production, with a Caesar resembling a contemporary president, provoked national controversy and lost sponsors. Critics debate who the hero is, Caesar or Brutus, and whether the assassination is presented as justified.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Julius Caesar returns to Rome in triumph, and some senators fear he will make himself king. Cassius sets out to persuade the respected Brutus to join a conspiracy. The play follows what they decide, what happens on the Ides of March, and how words, especially the speeches at Caesar's funeral, change the course of Rome.

Main themes

- power and ambition: is Caesar dangerous, or is the fear of him what is dangerous?
- honour and idealism: Brutus acts for "the general good"; ask whether good intentions are enough.
- rhetoric and persuasion: the play is a contest of speeches; watch how each speaker moves an audience.
- fate and omens: dreams, storms and soothsayers; does anyone listen?
- friendship and loyalty: Brutus and Cassius, Brutus and Caesar, Antony and Caesar.

Why it matters

The play asks questions every democracy faces: when is it right to resist a leader, and what happens when a crowd can be swayed by a good speech? It is also the best training ground in literature for analyzing persuasion, a skill students need every day.

Spoilers · teacher only

The conspirators stab Caesar in the Capitol. Brutus lets Antony speak at the funeral; Antony's oration turns the crowd, and the conspirators flee. Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list. Brutus and Cassius quarrel and reconcile; Portia has killed herself; Caesar's ghost visits Brutus. At Philippi Cassius has himself killed after misreading a report, and Brutus runs on his own sword; Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all."

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
>
> *Before we open Julius Caesar: Is it ever right to break a law or overthrow a leader to protect a country? Write for five minutes with one example.*
> **Prompt:** Before we open Julius Caesar: Is it ever right to break a law or overthrow a leader to protect a country? Write for five minutes with one example.

> **8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)**
>
> *republic (a state governed by elected representatives, not a king); tribune (an official representing the common people); conspiracy (a secret plan by a group); oration (a formal public speech); rhetoric (the art of persuasion: ethos, pathos, logos); soothsayer (a fortune-teller); the Ides of March (15 March).*

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

About the author. William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, married Anne Hathaway in 1582 and had three children, Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith. By the early 1590s he was writing and acting in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, the company that built the Globe on the south bank of the Thames in 1599. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays, including histories of English kings and tragedies drawn from Roman history, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. His fellow actors collected his plays in the First Folio of 1623. The world of the book. Julius Caesar dates from 1599, the year the Globe opened; a Swiss traveller, Thomas Platter, recorded seeing a play about Caesar at a Thameside playhouse on 21 September 1599. Shakespeare's source was Plutarch's Lives of the Noble Grecians and Romans in Thomas North's English translation (1579), which he followed closely, sometimes almost word for word. The historical Caesar was stabbed in the Senate house on the Ides of March (15 March) 44 BCE by senators led by Brutus and Cassius; Antony and Octavius defeated them at Philippi in 42 BCE. For English audiences in 1599 the story had urgent echoes: Queen Elizabeth I was old, had no heir, and the question of who would rule next, and whether resisting a ruler could ever be justified, was dangerous to discuss openly. Publication and reception. The play was first printed in the First Folio (1623), in an unusually clean text that is thought to come from a theatrical manuscript. It is the first of Shakespeare's Roman tragedies, followed by Antony and Cleopatra and Coriolanus. Then: It was popular from the start: the poet Leonard Digges, in verses printed in 1640, recalled audiences "ravish'd" by the quarrel scene between Brutus and Cassius while other plays emptied the house. It remained in the repertory after the Restoration and was among the most performed Shakespeare plays in the eighteenth century. Now: The play is a school standard, partly because it has little sexual content and centres on rhetoric and politics. Productions often make it about modern power: Orson Welles's 1937 Mercury Theatre staging dressed Caesar as a fascist dictator; Joseph Mankiewicz's 1953 film starred Marlon Brando as Antony; the Public Theater's 2017 Shakespeare in the Park production, with a Caesar resembling a contemporary president, provoked national controversy and lost sponsors. Critics debate who the hero is, Caesar or Brutus, and whether the assassination is presented as justified.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

"The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings" (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)). Cassius's line, among the most quoted in Shakespeare: a claim that people, not fate, are responsible. Ask students to watch whether the play agrees.

> *The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings* *(Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38))*

Think-aloud: "The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings" (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)). Cassius's line, among the most quoted in Shakespeare: a claim that people, not fate, are responsible. Ask students to watch whether the play agrees.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)

What the book is about (no spoilers): Julius Caesar returns to Rome in triumph, and some senators fear he will make himself king. Cassius sets out to persuade the respected Brutus to join a conspiracy. The play follows what they decide, what happens on the Ides of March, and how words, especially the speeches at Caesar's funeral, change the course of Rome. Themes to track: power and ambition: is Caesar dangerous, or is the fear of him what is dangerous? honour and idealism: Brutus acts for "the general good"; ask whether good intentions are enough. rhetoric and persuasion: the play is a contest of speeches; watch how each speaker moves an audience. fate and omens: dreams, storms and soothsayers; does anyone listen? friendship and loyalty: Brutus and Cassius, Brutus and Caesar, Antony and Caesar.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)

Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "rhetoric and persuasion": Prediction: someone will use a speech to change the crowd's mind. Question: is persuading people the same as manipulating them?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Julius Caesar: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page "rhetoric and persuasion": Prediction: someone will use a speech to change the crowd's mind. Question: is persuading people the same as manipulating them?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Why does Julius Caesar still matter? The play asks questions every democracy faces: when is it right to resist a leader, and what happens when a crowd can be swayed by a good speech? It is also the best training ground in literature for analyzing persuasion, a skill students need every day.
Anchor question: Why might Julius Caesar still be taught today?
Facilitation: The play asks questions every democracy faces: when is it right to resist a leader, and what happens when a crowd can be swayed by a good speech? It is also the best training ground in literature for analyzing persuasion, a skill students need every day.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)

Name one fact about Rome in 44 BCE or England in 1599 that helps explain the play's concerns. Answer: Examples: Rome was a republic and many feared Caesar would become king; Elizabeth I had no heir, so succession and the right to resist rulers were dangerous topics.
Exit ticket: Name one fact about Rome in 44 BCE or England in 1599 that helps explain the play's concerns.
Answer: Examples: Rome was a republic and many feared Caesar would become king; Elizabeth I had no heir, so succession and the right to resist rulers were dangerous topics.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)

Tomorrow we begin reading: Dramatis Personae.

Teacher notes · sources: Folger Shakespeare Library, "Julius Caesar" (https://www.folger.edu/explore/shakespeares-works/julius-caesar/); Royal Shakespeare Company, "Julius Caesar: about the play" (https://www.rsc.org.uk/julius-caesar/about-the-play); Plutarch, Lives, trans. Thomas North (1579), "The Life of Julius Caesar" and "The Life of Marcus Brutus" (https://www.gutenberg.org/); Thomas Platter's travel diary, 21 September 1599 (in E. K. Chambers, The Elizabethan Stage, vol. 2) (https://www.worldcat.org/); Leonard Digges, commendatory verses in Shakespeare's Poems (1640) (https://www.folger.edu/); New York Times coverage of the 2017 Public Theater production (https://www.nytimes.com/2017/06/12/theater/julius-caesar-public-theater-delta-bank-of-america.html)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Platter does not name the playhouse; most scholars identify it as the newly built Globe.
- Plutarch reports that Caesar spoke words to Brutus as he died (in Greek, "You too, child?" in some sources); the Latin "Et tu, Brute?" is not in Plutarch and appears in earlier English plays. Do not present it as Caesar's historical last words.

Lesson 2: Dramatis Personae

Focus: the cast and world of the play

Teacher only · spoilers

The cast list names Julius Caesar; the triumvirs who rule after his death (Octavius Caesar, Mark Antony, Lepidus); the conspirators (Marcus Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber, Cinna); senators, tribunes, a soothsayer, the teacher of rhetoric Artemidorus, two poets, soldiers and servants; and two women, Calpurnia and Portia. The action moves from Rome to Sardis and the plains of Philippi.

Background: Shakespeare wrote the play in 1599, late in the reign of Elizabeth I, who was old, childless and had named no successor. Fears of civil war after a ruler's death made a story about a murdered leader and the war that followed timely. The story comes from Plutarch's Lives in North's translation; the real Caesar was killed on 15 March 44 BC.

Significance: The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to power and ambition because....
Prompt: Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to power and ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: rhetoric — the art of persuasive speaking; disrobe — to strip (statues) of their decorations; handiwork — the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended); trophies — decorations hung in honor of a victory; cobbler — a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker).
Words: rhetoric: the art of persuasive speaking · disrobe: to strip (statues) of their decorations · handiwork: the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended) · trophies: decorations hung in honor of a victory · cobbler: a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker)

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Shakespeare wrote the play in 1599, late in the reign of Elizabeth I, who was old, childless and had named no successor. Fears of civil war after a ruler's death made a story about a murdered leader and the war that followed timely. The story comes from Plutarch's Lives in North's translation; the real Caesar was killed on 15 March 44 BC. The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life. Characterization: The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people. Structure: Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines. Setting: Rome, then Sardis and Philippi: the play moves from the city to the battlefield, from politics to war. Watch for omens and portents: Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "A Soothsayer" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Julius Caesar" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). The title character, who will die halfway through. That is characterization at work: The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people.

> *Julius Caesar (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Julius Caesar" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). The title character, who will die halfway through. That is characterization at work: The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. Look at the craft: Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines. Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition? Expected: Every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. (Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.)

> *Marcus Brutus (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. Look at the craft: Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines.
Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition?
Expected answer: Every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. (Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the cast and world of the play? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the cast and world of the play. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. When the text says "Julius Caesar" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)), it shows this directly. Caesar, Antony and Octavius head one list, and Brutus, Cassius and the other conspirators another, so the play begins as a map of loyalty and opposition.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the cast and world of the play? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the cast and world of the play. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. When the text says "Julius Caesar" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)), it shows this directly. Caesar, Antony and Octavius head one list, and Brutus, Cassius and the other conspirators another, so the play begins as a map of loyalty and opposition.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first? Ask students to predict, from names and groups, who will matter most.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first?
Facilitation: Ask students to predict, from names and groups, who will matter most.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the cast and world of the play? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. ("Julius Caesar", Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the cast and world of the play? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. ("Julius Caesar", Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the cast and world of the play. Key takeaway: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people.
- **Structure:** Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines.
- **Setting:** Rome, then Sardis and Philippi: the play moves from the city to the battlefield, from politics to war.

Themes and how they develop

- **power and ambition:** every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power.

Symbols and motifs

- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "A Soothsayer" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)).
- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: "Senators, citizens, guards, attendants, etc" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Julius Caesar" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)) The title character, who will die halfway through.
- "Marcus Brutus" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)) Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone.
- "Calpurnia" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)) One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power.
Evidence: "Julius Caesar" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0))
Reasoning: Caesar, Antony and Octavius head one list, and Brutus, Cassius and the other conspirators another, so the play begins as a map of loyalty and opposition.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
rhetoric (noun)	the art of persuasive speaking	*Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of rhetoric*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disrobe (verb)	to strip (statues) of their decorations	*Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck'd with ceremonies.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
handiwork (noun)	the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)	*As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather have gone upon my handiwork.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
trophies (noun)	decorations hung in honor of a victory	*It is no matter; let no images Be hung with Caesar's trophies.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cobbler (noun)	a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker)	*Truly, sir, in respect of a fine workman, I am but, as you would say, a cobbler.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ingratitude (noun)	failure to show thanks	*Run to your houses, fall upon your knees, Pray to the gods to intermit the plague That needs must light on this ingratitude.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
naughty (adjective)	wicked; good-for-nothing	*What trade, thou knave? thou naughty knave, what trade?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
surgeon (noun)	one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes)	*I am, indeed, sir, a surgeon to old shoes; when they are in great danger, I recover them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which characters on the cast list are conspirators against Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber and Cinna.

2. Who are the two women named in the cast list? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Calpurnia and Portia
3. Which three men become triumvirs after Caesar's death? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Octavius, Antony and Lepidus
4. Whom is Calpurnia married to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Caesar
5. Where does the final battle of the play take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Philippi
6. What is Artemidorus's profession? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A teacher of rhetoric
7. Retell the three most important events of "Dramatis Personae" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The cast list names Julius Caesar; the triumvirs who rule after his death (Octavius Caesar, Mark Antony, Lepidus); the conspirators (Marcus Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber, Cinna); senators, tribunes, a soothsayer, the teacher of rhetoric Artemidorus, two poets, soldiers and servants; and two women, Calpurnia and Portia. The action moves from Rome to…
8. Who is on stage in "Dramatis Personae", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Dramatis Personae" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of rhetoric" What does "rhetoric" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: rhetoric: the art of persuasive speaking.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might a play about killing a ruler have felt dangerous in London in 1599? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Elizabeth was old with no named heir; succession and rebellion were live fears.
2. What does "Dramatis Personae" suggest about the cast and world of the play? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: "Julius Caesar" (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The title character, who will die halfway through. On characterization: The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Julius Caesar”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Dramatis Personae”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: The cast list names Julius Caesar; the triumvirs who rule after his death (Octavius Caesar, Mark Antony, Lepidus); the conspirators (Marcus Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber, Cinna); senators, tribunes, a soothsayer, the teacher of rhetoric Artemidorus, two…
7. As the opening scene, what does “Dramatis Personae” set up that the rest of Julius Caesar will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. On structure: Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Calpurnia” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands. On characterization: The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The title character, who will die halfway through. On structure: Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. The play is named for Caesar, yet he appears in few scenes. Who do you predict is the true center of the play, and why? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Brutus is a strong case: his choices and conscience drive the plot.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's

power. Useful evidence: “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Calpurnia” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The title character, who will die halfway through. On characterization: The cast is divided by politics: Caesar; the triumvirs after his death (Antony, Octavius, Lepidus); the conspirators; senators; tribunes; the citizens. Students should see the factions before they see the people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Dramatis Personae”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the cast and world of the play. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. On structure: Caesar, the title character, dies in Act III; the cast list does not tell us that Brutus has the most lines. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Dramatis Personae”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Calpurnia” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The title character, who

will die halfway through. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. On setting: Rome, then Sardis and Philippi: the play moves from the city to the battlefield, from politics to war. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Dramatis Personae” treats the cast and world of the play with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Calpurnia” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): One of only two women, both wives who are not heard by their husbands. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Julius Caesar” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): The title character, who will die halfway through. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list shows a world organized around one man's power. Useful evidence: “Marcus Brutus” (Dramatis Personae, speech (speech 0)): Listed among the conspirators; he has more lines than anyone. Theme link: every group is defined by its relation to Caesar's power. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz

1. Who are the two women named in the cast list?
    A. Lucretia and Portia
    B. Calpurnia and Cleopatra
    C. Calpurnia and Portia
    D. Portia and Octavia
2. Which three men become triumvirs after Caesar's death?
    A. Antony, Cicero and Lepidus
    B. Octavius, Antony and Lepidus
    C. Brutus, Cassius and Casca
    D. Octavius, Brutus and Antony
3. Whom is Calpurnia married to?
    A. Brutus
    B. Cassius
    C. Caesar
    D. Antony
4. Where does the final battle of the play take place?
    A. Rome
    B. Pharsalus
    C. Sardis
    D. Philippi
5. What is Artemidorus's profession?
    A. A senator
    B. A poet
    C. A soothsayer
    D. A teacher of rhetoric
6. In the line “Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of rhetoric”, what does “rhetoric” most nearly mean?
    A. to strip (statues) of their decorations
    B. decorations hung in honor of a victory
    C. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)
    D. the art of persuasive speaking
7. In the line “Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck’d with ceremonies.”, what does “disrobe” most nearly mean?
    A. to strip (statues) of their decorations
    B. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)
    C. the art of persuasive speaking
    D. decorations hung in honor of a victory

Answer key: 1. C (Calpurnia and Portia); 2. B (Octavius, Antony and Lepidus); 3. C (Caesar); 4. D (Philippi); 5. D (A teacher of rhetoric); 6. D (the art of persuasive speaking); 7. A (to strip (statues) of their decorations)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Dramatis Personae," how does Shakespeare show the cast and world of the play? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Dramatis Personae, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the cast and world of the play? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the cast and world of the play. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Dramatis Personae (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the cast and world of the play. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Dramatis Personae suggests about the cast and world of the play. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Dramatis Personae to complicate the reader's understanding of the cast and world of the play. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Dramatis Personae within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the cast and world of the play responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Dramatis Personae alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the cast and world of the play follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Dramatis Personae and its treatment of the cast and world of the play. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Dramatis Personae as evidence for a larger claim about the cast and world of the play in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Dramatis Personae as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the cast and world of the play. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather have gone upon my handiwork.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "handiwork" most nearly mean?

   A. one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes)

   B. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)

   C. wicked; good-for-nothing

   D. failure to show thanks

2. *Julius Caesar*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Dramatis Personae"?

   A. The funeral orations

   B. Brutus and Cassius at odds

   C. Artemidorus's letter

   D. The cast and world of the play

SAT key: 1. B (the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)); 2. D (The cast and world of the play)

Lesson 3: Act I, Scene I

Focus: the tribunes and the fickle crowd

Teacher only · spoilers

Commoners take a holiday to celebrate Caesar's triumph over Pompey's sons. The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold them; a cobbler answers with puns. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey, calls them ungrateful, and sends them home. The tribunes then go to strip decorations from Caesar's statues so that he will not soar 'above the view of men.'

Background: Tribunes were officials elected to protect ordinary citizens (plebeians). Caesar had defeated Pompey in civil war and then Pompey's sons in 45 BC. Celebrating a victory over fellow Romans was controversial.

Significance: The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because....*
> **Prompt:** Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: disrobe — to strip (statues) of their decorations; handiwork — the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended); trophies — decorations hung in honor of a victory; cobbler — a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker); ingratitude — failure to show thanks.*
> **Words:** disrobe: to strip (statues) of their decorations · handiwork: the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended) · trophies: decorations hung in honor of a victory · cobbler: a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker) · ingratitude: failure to show thanks

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Tribunes were officials elected to protect ordinary citizens (plebeians). Caesar had defeated Pompey in civil war and then Pompey's sons in 45 BC. Celebrating a victory over fellow Romans was controversial. The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes. Characterization: The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too. Dialogue: The cobbler's puns ("a mender of bad soles") show the commoners' wit and the tribunes' contempt. Foreshadowing: The tribunes strip Caesar's statues and are "put to silence": early warning of the danger of opposing Caesar. Watch for blood: Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: "flowers in his way / That comes in triumph over Pompey's blood? / Be gone! / Run to your houses, fall upon your knees, / Pray" (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things" (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)). Marullus's contempt for the crowd. That is characterization at work: The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too.

> *You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things* (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things" (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)). Marullus's contempt for the crowd. That is characterization at work: The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The feather metaphor: Caesar is a bird rising too high; they want to keep him "ordinary." Power and ambition. Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion? Expected: The crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. (The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.)

> *These growing feathers pluck'd from Caesar's wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch* (Act I, Scene I, Flavius (speech 18))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The feather metaphor: Caesar is a bird rising too high; they want to keep him "ordinary." Power and ambition.
Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion?
Expected answer: The crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. (The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. When the text says "You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things" (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)), it shows this directly. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey and calls them "you blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things," and the tribunes plan to pluck "growing feathers" from Caesar's wing.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. When the text says “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)), it shows this directly. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey and calls them "you blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things," and the tribunes plan to pluck "growing feathers" from Caesar's wing.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change? Ask: is the crowd foolish, or are the tribunes snobs? Use the cobbler's jokes.

Anchor question: Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change?

Facilitation: Ask: is the crowd foolish, or are the tribunes snobs? Use the cobbler's jokes.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. (“You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things”, Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. (“You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things”, Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Key takeaway: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too.
- **Dialogue:** The cobbler's puns ("a mender of bad soles") show the commoners' wit and the tribunes' contempt.
- **Foreshadowing:** The tribunes strip Caesar's statues and are "put to silence": early warning of the danger of opposing Caesar.

Themes and how they develop

- **rhetoric and persuasion:** the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit.

Symbols and motifs

- **blood:** Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: “flowers in his way / That comes in triumph over Pompey’s blood? / Be gone! / Run to your houses, fall upon your knees, / Pray” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)).
- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: “Rome. A street” (Act I, Scene I, speech (speech 0)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)) Marullus's contempt for the crowd.
- “a mender of bad soles” (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner (speech 6)) The cobbler's pun on soles/souls.
- “These growing feathers pluck’d from Caesar’s wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch” (Act I, Scene I, Flavius (speech 18)) The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful.
Evidence: “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15))
Reasoning: Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey and calls them "you blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things," and the tribunes plan to pluck "growing feathers" from Caesar's wing.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
disrobe (verb)	to strip (statues) of their decorations	*Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck'd with ceremonies.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
handiwork (noun)	the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)	*As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather have gone upon my handiwork.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
trophies (noun)	decorations hung in honor of a victory	*It is no matter; let no images Be hung with Caesar's trophies.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cobbler (noun)	a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker)	*Truly, sir, in respect of a fine workman, I am but, as you would say, a cobbler.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ingratitude (noun)	failure to show thanks	*Run to your houses, fall upon your knees, Pray to the gods to intermit the plague That needs must light on this ingratitude.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
naughty (adjective)	wicked; good-for-nothing	*What trade, thou knave? thou naughty knave, what trade?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
surgeon (noun)	one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes)	*I am, indeed, sir, a surgeon to old shoes; when they are in great danger, I recover them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
beseech (verb)	to beg	*Nay, I beseech you, sir, be not out with me: yet, if you be out, sir, I can mend you.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Marullus say the crowd once did for Pompey? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Climbed walls and towers and waited all day to see him pass.

2. Why are the commoners out in the streets? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To celebrate Caesar's triumph
3. What trade does the punning commoner follow? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Cobbler
4. Whose earlier triumphs does Marullus remind the crowd they cheered? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Pompey's
5. What do the tribunes plan to do to Caesar's statues? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Strip off their decorations
6. How do Flavius and Marullus feel about Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: They oppose his rising power
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Commoners take a holiday to celebrate Caesar's triumph over Pompey's sons. The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold them; a cobbler answers with puns. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey, calls them ungrateful, and sends them home. The tribunes then go to strip decorations from Caesar's statues so that he will not soar 'above the view of men.'
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck'd with ceremonies." What does "disrobe" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: disrobe: to strip (statues) of their decorations.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Flavius's image of plucking 'feathers' from Caesar's wing suggest about how he sees Caesar? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: As a bird of prey who would fly too high and rule over others.
2. What does "Act I, Scene I" suggest about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: "You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things" (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)): Marullus's contempt for the crowd. On characterization: The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar,

reminding them that they cheered Pompey too. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Truly, sir, all that I live by is with the awl: I meddle with no tradesman’s matters, nor women’s matters, but with awl.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Commoners take a holiday to celebrate Caesar's triumph over Pompey's sons. The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold them; a cobbler answers with puns. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey, calls them ungrateful, and sends them home. The tribunes then go to strip decorations from Caesar's…
7. How does “Act I, Scene I” build on “Dramatis Personae”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “a mender of bad soles” (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner (speech 6)): The cobbler's pun on soles/souls. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “These growing feathers pluck’d from Caesar’s wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch” (Act I, Scene I, Flavius (speech 18)): The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power. On characterization: The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)): Marullus's contempt for the crowd. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the tribunes defending the people or insulting them? Use their words to argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Both: they guard the republic but call the people blocks and stones.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “a mender of bad soles” (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner (speech 6)): The cobbler's pun on soles/souls. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “These growing feathers pluck’d from Caesar’s wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch” (Act I, Scene I, Flavius (speech 18)): The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)): Marullus's contempt for the crowd. On characterization: The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold the cobbler and carpenter for celebrating Caesar, reminding them that they cheered Pompey too. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “a mender of bad soles” (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner (speech 6)): The cobbler's pun on soles/souls. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “These growing feathers pluck’d from Caesar’s wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch” (Act I, Scene I, Flavius (speech 18)): The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)): Marullus's contempt for the crowd. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “a mender of bad soles” (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner (speech 6)): The cobbler's pun on soles/souls. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene I” treats the tribunes and the fickle crowd with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “These growing feathers pluck’d from Caesar’s wing / Will make him fly an ordinary pitch” (Act I, Scene I, Flavius (speech 18)): The tribunes' metaphor of limiting Caesar's power. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “You blocks, you stones, you worse than senseless things” (Act I, Scene I, Marullus (speech 15)): Marullus's contempt for the crowd. On foreshadowing: The tribunes strip Caesar's statues and are "put to silence": early warning of the danger of opposing Caesar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene shows a crowd that changes loyalties easily, which is what makes the later speeches so powerful. Useful evidence: “a mender of bad soles” (Act I, Scene I, Second Commoner (speech 6)): The cobbler's pun on soles/souls. Theme link: the crowd is fickle, the central fact the funeral orations will exploit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz

1. Why are the commoners out in the streets?
   A. To protest taxes
   B. To elect tribunes
   C. To celebrate Caesar's triumph
   D. To see a play
2. What trade does the punning commoner follow?
   A. Baker
   B. Butcher
   C. Cobbler
   D. Carpenter
3. Whose earlier triumphs does Marullus remind the crowd they cheered?
   A. Antony's
   B. Pompey's
   C. Cicero's
   D. Brutus's
4. What do the tribunes plan to do to Caesar's statues?
   A. Paint them
   B. Strip off their decorations
   C. Guard them
   D. Pull them down
5. How do Flavius and Marullus feel about Caesar?
   A. They fear the crowd more than him
   B. They oppose his rising power
   C. They love him
   D. They do not care
6. In the line “Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck’d with ceremonies.”, what does “disrobe” most nearly mean?
   A. decorations hung in honor of a victory
   B. a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker)
   C. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)
   D. to strip (statues) of their decorations

7. In the line “As proper men as ever trod upon neat’s leather have gone upon my handiwork.”, what does “handiwork” most nearly mean?

   A. decorations hung in honor of a victory

   B. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)

   C. to strip (statues) of their decorations

   D. a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker)

Answer key: 1. C (To celebrate Caesar's triumph); 2. C (Cobbler); 3. B (Pompey's); 4. B (Strip off their decorations); 5. B (They oppose his rising power); 6. D (to strip (statues) of their decorations); 7. B (the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended))

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the tribunes and the fickle crowd? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the tribunes and the fickle crowd? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene I suggests about the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act I, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the tribunes and the

fickle crowd responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the tribunes and the fickle crowd follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene I and its treatment of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the tribunes and the fickle crowd in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *It is no matter; let no images Be hung with Caesar's trophies.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "trophies" most nearly mean?

   A. wicked; good-for-nothing

   B. to beg

   C. decorations hung in honor of a victory

   D. one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes)

2. *Truly, sir, all that I live by is with the awl: I meddle with no tradesman's matters, nor women's matters, but with awl. I am, indeed, sir, a surgeon to old shoes; when they are in great danger, I recover them. As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather have gone upon my handiwork.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene I"?

   A. The funeral orations

   B. Parley before battle

   C. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

   D. Cinna the poet

SAT key: 1. C (decorations hung in honor of a victory); 2. C (The tribunes and the fickle crowd)

Lesson 4: Act I, Scene II

Focus: Cassius works on Brutus

Teacher only · spoilers

At the feast of Lupercal a soothsayer warns Caesar to beware the ides of March; Caesar dismisses him. Cassius probes Brutus, who admits he fears the people will choose Caesar for king. Cassius tells how he saved Caesar from drowning and saw him sick with fever, and argues 'the fault... is not in our stars, but in ourselves.' Caesar tells Antony he distrusts Cassius's 'lean and hungry look.' Casca reports that Caesar refused a crown offered three times by Antony and then fell in a fit. Alone, Cassius plans to throw forged letters in Brutus's window.

Background: The Lupercalia was a February fertility festival. The 'ides' of March was 15 March. Caesar was made dictator for life in early 44 BC, which alarmed defenders of the republic.

Significance: This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to power and ambition because....
Prompt: When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to power and ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: bestride — to stand over with legs wide apart; coronets — small crowns; underlings — inferiors; people of low rank; cogitations — thoughts; encompass — to enclose; to contain.
Words: bestride: to stand over with legs wide apart · coronets: small crowns · underlings: inferiors; people of low rank · cogitations: thoughts · encompass: to enclose; to contain

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Lupercalia was a February fertility festival. The 'ides' of March was 15 March. Caesar was made dictator for life in early 44 BC, which alarmed defenders of the republic. This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose. Characterization: Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius. Dramatic irony: Offstage shouts (Caesar refusing the crown three times) punctuate the persuasion; Casca's mocking report undercuts Caesar's show of modesty. Rhetoric: Cassius uses anecdote (Caesar drowning in the Tiber, shaking with fever) to make Caesar seem merely human. Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Beware the ides of March" (Act I, Scene II, Soothsayer (speech 14)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings" (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)). Cassius's argument for action. That is characterization at work: Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius.

> *The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings* *(Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings" (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)). Cassius's argument for action. That is characterization at work: Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The Colossus was a giant statue at Rhodes; the image makes Romans small beneath Caesar. Expected link: power and ambition, and Cassius's rhetoric. Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition? Expected: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. (Caesar reads Cassius accurately.)

> *Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous (Act I, Scene II, Caesar (speech 47))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The Colossus was a giant statue at Rhodes; the image makes Romans small beneath Caesar. Expected link: power and ambition, and Cassius's rhetoric.
Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition?
Expected answer: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. (Caesar reads Cassius accurately.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Cassius works on Brutus? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Cassius works on Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. When the text says “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)), it shows this directly. He says Caesar "doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus" while others are "underlings," and insists "the fault ... is not in our stars, / But in ourselves," urging Brutus to act.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Cassius works on Brutus? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Cassius works on Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. When the text says “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)), it shows this directly. He says Caesar "doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus" while others are "underlings," and insists "the fault ... is not in our stars, / But in ourselves," urging Brutus to act.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell? Ask students to list Cassius's persuasive moves. Which would work on them?
Anchor question: When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell?
Facilitation: Ask students to list Cassius's persuasive moves. Which would work on them?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Cassius works on Brutus? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. ("The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings", Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Cassius works on Brutus? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. ("The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings", Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Cassius works on Brutus. Key takeaway: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius.
- **Dramatic irony:** Offstage shouts (Caesar refusing the crown three times) punctuate the persuasion; Casca's mocking report undercuts Caesar's show of modesty.
- **Rhetoric:** Cassius uses anecdote (Caesar drowning in the Tiber, shaking with fever) to make Caesar seem merely human.

Themes and how they develop

- **power and ambition:** Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection.

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: “Beware the ides of March” (Act I, Scene II, Soothsayer (speech 14)).
- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: “Cassius, and Casca; a great crowd following, among them a Soothsayer” (Act I, Scene II, speech (speech 0)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)) Cassius's argument for action.
- “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar (speech 47)) Caesar reads Cassius accurately.
- “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)) Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power.
Evidence: “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38))
Reasoning: He says Caesar "doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus" while others are "underlings," and insists "the fault ... is not in our stars, / But in ourselves," urging Brutus to act.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bestride (verb)	to stand over with legs wide apart	*Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world Like a Colossus, and we petty men Walk under his huge legs and peep about To find ourselves dishonourable graves.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
coronets (noun)	small crowns	*I saw Mark Antony offer him a crown;—yet ’twas not a crown neither, ’twas one of these coronets;—and, as I told you, he put it by once: but, for all that, to my thinking, he would fain have had it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
underlings (noun)	inferiors; people of low rank	*Men at some time are masters of their fates: The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, But in ourselves, that we are underlings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cogitations (noun)	thoughts	*Then, Brutus, I have much mistook your passion; By means whereof this breast of mine hath buried Thoughts of great value, worthy cogitations.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

encompass (verb)	to enclose; to contain	*When could they say till now, that talk'd of Rome, That her wide walls encompass'd but one man?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
foolery (noun)	foolish behavior; nonsense	*I can as well be hanged as tell the manner of it: it was mere foolery; I did not mark it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wenches (noun)	young women (informal, period term)	*Three or four wenches, where I stood, cried "Alas, good soul!" and forgave him with all their hearts: but there's no heed to be taken of them: if Caesar had stabbed their mothers, they would have done no less.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enterprise (noun)	a bold undertaking	*So is he now in execution Of any bold or noble enterprise, However he puts on this tardy form.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chanced (verb)	happened	*Ay, Casca; tell us what hath chanced to-day, That Caesar looks so sad.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ceremony (noun)	formal politeness	*Set on; and leave no ceremony out.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Brutus admit he fears when he hears the crowd shout? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: That the people choose Caesar for their king.
2. What does the soothsayer warn Caesar to beware? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The ides of March
3. From what danger does Cassius say he once saved Caesar? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Drowning in the Tiber

4. How many times does Antony offer Caesar the crown, according to Casca? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Three
5. What does Caesar say about Cassius's appearance? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He has a lean and hungry look
6. What does Cassius plan to put in Brutus's window? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Letters in several hands
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: At the feast of Lupercal a soothsayer warns Caesar to beware the ides of March; Caesar dismisses him. Cassius probes Brutus, who admits he fears the people will choose Caesar for king. Cassius tells how he saved Caesar from drowning and saw him sick with fever, and argues 'the fault... is not in our stars, but in ourselves.' Caesar tells Antony he distrusts Cassius's 'lean and hungry look.' Casca…
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world Like a Colossus, and we petty men Walk under his huge legs and peep about To find ourselves dishonourable graves." What does "bestride" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: bestride: to stand over with legs wide apart.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Cassius tell stories of Caesar's physical weakness? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: To show Caesar is only a man, no greater than Brutus or Cassius.
2. What does "Act I, Scene II" suggest about Cassius works on Brutus? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about Cassius works on Brutus? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: "The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings" (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)): Cassius's argument for action. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Marry, before he fell down, when he perceived the common herd was glad he refused the crown, he plucked me ope his doublet and offered them his throat to cut.", why might

Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: At the feast of Lupercal a soothsayer warns Caesar to beware the ides of March; Caesar dismisses him. Cassius probes Brutus, who admits he fears the people will choose Caesar for king. Cassius tells how he saved Caesar from drowning and saw him sick with fever, and argues 'the fault... is not in…
7. How does “Act I, Scene II” build on “Act I, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar (speech 47)): Caesar reads Cassius accurately. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)): Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness. On characterization: Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)): Cassius's argument for action. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. 'The fault... is not in our stars, but in ourselves.' Does the play prove Cassius right or wrong? Revisit this at the end. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Debatable: omens come true, yet characters' choices cause each disaster.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He

thinks too much: such men are dangerous" (Act I, Scene II, Caesar (speech 47)): Caesar reads Cassius accurately. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: "This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: "Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus" (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)): Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: "The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings" (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)): Cassius's argument for action. On characterization: Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Act I, Scene II". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Cassius works on Brutus. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: "Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous" (Act I, Scene II, Caesar (speech 47)): Caesar reads Cassius accurately. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "Act I, Scene II": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: "Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus" (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)): Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)): Cassius's argument for action. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar (speech 47)): Caesar reads Cassius accurately. On characterization: Cassius works on Brutus through flattery, envy and appeals to Roman honour; Brutus admits he fears "the people / Choose Caesar for their king." Caesar, observed close up, is deaf in one ear and suspicious of "lean and hungry" Cassius. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene II” treats Cassius works on Brutus with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world / Like a Colossus” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)): Cassius's image of Caesar's size and his own smallness. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, / But in ourselves, that we are underlings” (Act I, Scene II, Cassius (speech 38)): Cassius's argument for action. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Cassius works on Brutus? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius persuades by making Caesar seem both too great and too ordinary to deserve power. Useful evidence: “Yond Cassius has a lean and hungry look; / He thinks too much: such men are dangerous” (Act I, Scene II, Caesar (speech 47)): Caesar reads Cassius accurately. Theme link: Cassius argues that men, not fate, make their own subjection. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What does the soothsayer warn Caesar to beware?
   A. The Capitol
   B. Cassius
   C. The Lupercal
   D. The ides of March
2. From what danger does Cassius say he once saved Caesar?
   A. A wild boar
   B. An assassin
   C. Drowning in the Tiber
   D. A fire
3. How many times does Antony offer Caesar the crown, according to Casca?
   A. Once
   B. Three
   C. Twice
   D. Five
4. What does Caesar say about Cassius's appearance?
   A. He looks ill
   B. He looks like a king
   C. He looks too cheerful
   D. He has a lean and hungry look
5. What does Cassius plan to put in Brutus's window?
   A. Letters in several hands
   B. A crown
   C. A warning from Calpurnia
   D. A dagger
6. In the line “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world Like a Colossus, and we petty men Walk under his huge legs and peep about To find ourselves dishonourable graves.”, what does “bestride” most nearly mean?
   A. small crowns

B. inferiors; people of low rank

C. thoughts

D. to stand over with legs wide apart

7. In the line "I saw Mark Antony offer him a crown;—yet 'twas not a crown neither, 'twas one of these coronets;—and, as I told you, he put it by once: but, for all that, to my thinking, he would fain have had it.", what does "coronets" most nearly mean?

A. inferiors; people of low rank

B. to stand over with legs wide apart

C. thoughts

D. small crowns

Answer key: 1. D (The ides of March); 2. C (Drowning in the Tiber); 3. B (Three); 4. D (He has a lean and hungry look); 5. A (Letters in several hands); 6. D (to stand over with legs wide apart); 7. D (small crowns)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act I, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show Cassius works on Brutus? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Cassius works on Brutus? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Cassius works on Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Cassius works on Brutus. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene II suggests about Cassius works on Brutus. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act I, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Cassius works on Brutus. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Cassius works on Brutus responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Cassius works on Brutus follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene II and its treatment of Cassius works on Brutus. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Cassius works on Brutus in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Cassius works on Brutus. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Men at some time are masters of their fates: The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, But in ourselves, that we are underlings.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “underlings” most nearly mean?

   A. inferiors; people of low rank

   B. formal politeness

   C. a bold undertaking

   D. happened

2. *Marry, before he fell down, when he perceived the common herd was glad he refused the crown, he plucked me ope his doublet and offered them his throat to cut. An I had been a man of any occupation, if I would not have taken him at a word, I would I might go to hell among the rogues. And so he fell. When he came to himself again, he said, If he had done or said anything amiss, he desired their worships to think it was his infirmity. Three or four wenches, where I stood, cried “Alas, good soul!” and forgave him with all their hearts: but there’s no heed to be taken of them: if Caesar had stabbed their mothers, they would have done no less.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene II”?

   A. The assassination

   B. Artemidorus's letter

C. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

D. Cassius works on Brutus

SAT key: 1. A (inferiors; people of low rank); 2. D (Cassius works on Brutus)

Lesson 5: Act I, Scene III

Focus: storm, omens and recruitment

Teacher only · spoilers

On a night of thunder and strange sights (a slave's burning hand that does not burn, a lion near the Capitol, men on fire walking the streets, an owl hooting at noon), Casca meets Cicero and then Cassius. Cassius reads the omens as warnings against Caesar's tyranny and wins Casca to the plot. Cinna joins them; Cassius sends him to place forged letters where Brutus will find them, and they agree that Brutus's good name will make their deed look like virtue.

Background: Romans read storms and unusual events (prodigies) as messages from the gods. Plutarch records omens before Caesar's death. Cicero, a famous orator, was not part of the plot.

Significance: The same omens are read in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because....
Prompt: Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: each character reads the omens to suit himself.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: bondman — a slave; construe — to interpret; to explain; illuminate — make lighter or brighter; alchemy — the supposed art of turning base metal to gold; shrieking — crying out with a high scream.
Words: bondman: a slave · construe: to interpret; to explain · illuminate: make lighter or brighter · alchemy: the supposed art of turning base metal to gold · shrieking: crying out with a high scream

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Romans read storms and unusual events (prodigies) as messages from the gods. Plutarch records omens before Caesar's death. Cicero, a famous orator, was not part of the plot. The same omens are read in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion. Setting: A violent storm with omens (a lion in the Capitol, men on fire, a bird of night at noon). Characterization: Casca is terrified; Cassius bares his chest to the lightning and interprets the omens as warnings against Caesar. Plot: Cassius plans to throw forged letters in Brutus's window. Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Be you content: good Cinna, take this paper, / And look you lay it in the praetor's chair, / Where Brutus" (Act I, Scene III, Cassius (speech 33)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)). Cicero on interpreting omens. That is setting at work: A violent storm with omens (a lion in the Capitol, men on fire, a bird of night at noon).

> *men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves* (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)). Cicero on interpreting omens. That is setting at work: A violent storm with omens (a lion in the Capitol, men on fire, a bird of night at noon).

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Cicero's line is a warning about bias; Cassius proves it. Expected link: fate and omens. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens? Expected: Each character reads the omens to suit himself. (Cassius's willingness to die.)

> *Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius* (Act I, Scene III, Cassius (speech 21))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Cicero's line is a warning about bias; Cassius proves it. Expected link: fate and omens.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens?
Expected answer: Each character reads the omens to suit himself. (Cassius's willingness to die.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about storm, omens and recruitment? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of storm, omens and recruitment. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. When the text says "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)), it shows this directly. Cicero warns that "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves," and Cassius promptly reads the storm as a sign against Caesar.
Task: Annotate the scene for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about storm, omens and recruitment? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of storm, omens and recruitment. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. When the text says "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves" (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)), it shows this directly. Cicero warns that "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves," and Cassius promptly reads the storm as a sign against Caesar.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe? Ask: why does Cassius need Brutus? Use Casca's line.
Anchor question: Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Cassius need Brutus? Use Casca's line.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about storm, omens and recruitment? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. ("men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves", Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about storm, omens and recruitment? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. ("men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves", Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how setting shapes storm, omens and recruitment. Key takeaway: each character reads the omens to suit himself.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** A violent storm with omens (a lion in the Capitol, men on fire, a bird of night at noon).
- **Characterization:** Casca is terrified; Cassius bares his chest to the lightning and interprets the omens as warnings against Caesar.
- **Plot:** Cassius plans to throw forged letters in Brutus's window.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** each character reads the omens to suit himself.

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: “Be you content: good Cinna, take this paper, / And look you lay it in the praetor’s chair, / Where Brutus” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius (speech 33)).
- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: “at noon-day upon the market-place, / Hooting and shrieking. When these prodigies / Do so conjointly meet, let not men say / “These are their” (Act I, Scene III, Casca (speech 4)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)) Cicero on interpreting omens.
- “Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius (speech 21)) Cassius's willingness to die.
- “O, he sits high in all the people’s hearts” (Act I, Scene III, Casca (speech 36)) Casca on Brutus's reputation.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish.
Evidence: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5))
Reasoning: Cicero warns that "men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves," and Cassius promptly reads the storm as a sign against Caesar.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	

	Definition (in this sentence)		Word history
bondman (noun)	a slave	*So can I: So every bondman in his own hand bears The power to cancel his captivity.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
construe (verb)	to interpret; to explain	*Indeed, it is a strange-disposed time: But men may construe things after their fashion, Clean from the purpose of the things themselves.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
illuminate (verb)	make lighter or brighter	*Those that with haste will make a mighty fire Begin it with weak straws: what trash is Rome, What rubbish and what offal, when it serves For the base matter to illuminate So vile a thing as Caesar!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
alchemy (noun)	the supposed art of turning base metal to gold	*O, he sits high in all the people's hearts: And that which would appear offence in us, His countenance, like richest alchemy, Will change to virtue and to worthiness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
shrieking (verb)	crying out with a high scream	*And yesterday the bird of night did sit Even at noon-day upon the market-place, Hooting and shrieking.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conceited (verb)	understood; judged (well conceited: rightly grasped)	*Him and his worth and our great need of him You have right well conceited.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
husbanded (adjective)	married; having a husband	*Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father'd and so husbanded?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dismember (verb)	to cut the limbs from a body	*We all stand up against the spirit of Caesar; And in the spirit of men there is no blood: O, that we then could come by Caesar's spirit, And not dismember Caesar!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Casca say the senators plan to do tomorrow? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Establish Caesar as king, to wear his crown everywhere except in Italy.
2. What strange sight does Casca report about a slave's hand? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It burned but was not scorched
3. Which wild animal does Casca say he met near the Capitol? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A lion
4. How does Cassius interpret the storm? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: As a warning against Caesar's tyranny
5. Who is sent to place the letters for Brutus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Cinna
6. Why do the conspirators want Brutus to join them? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His good reputation will make the deed seem worthy
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: On a night of thunder and strange sights (a slave's burning hand that does not burn, a lion near the Capitol, men on fire walking the streets, an owl hooting at noon), Casca meets Cicero and then Cassius. Cassius reads the omens as warnings against Caesar's tyranny and wins Casca to the plot. Cinna joins them; Cassius sends him to place forged letters where Brutus will find them, and they agree…
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "So can I: So every bondman in his own hand bears The power to cancel his captivity." What does "bondman" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: bondman: a slave.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Cassius say he would rather die than live under Caesar? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: He believes Romans who accept a tyrant become slaves; he will free himself.
2. What does "Act I, Scene III" suggest about storm, omens and recruitment? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The same omens are read in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about storm, omens and recruitment? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted

however people wish. Useful evidence: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)): Cicero on interpreting omens. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “A common slave—you know him well by sight— Held up his left hand, which did flame and burn Like twenty torches join’d, and yet his hand, Not sensible of fire, remain’d unscorch’d.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: On a night of thunder and strange sights (a slave's burning hand that does not burn, a lion near the Capitol, men on fire walking the streets, an owl hooting at noon), Casca meets Cicero and then Cassius. Cassius reads the omens as warnings against Caesar's tyranny and wins Casca to the plot. Cinna…
7. How does “Act I, Scene III” build on “Act I, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius (speech 21)): Cassius's willingness to die. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “O, he sits high in all the people’s hearts” (Act I, Scene III, Casca (speech 36)): Casca on Brutus's reputation. On characterization: Casca is terrified; Cassius bares his chest to the lightning and interprets the omens as warnings against Caesar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)): Cicero on interpreting omens. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is it fair for the conspirators to use Brutus's reputation? What does that suggest about their cause? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: They borrow his virtue as cover; it suggests the cause needs disguising.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius (speech 21)): Cassius's willingness to die. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The same omens are read in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “O, he sits high in all the people’s hearts” (Act I, Scene III, Casca (speech 36)): Casca on Brutus's reputation. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)): Cicero on interpreting omens. On characterization: Casca is terrified; Cassius bares his chest to the lightning and interprets the omens as warnings against Caesar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of storm, omens and recruitment. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius (speech 21)): Cassius's willingness to die. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “O, he sits high in all the people’s hearts” (Act I, Scene III, Casca (speech 36)): Casca on Brutus's reputation. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)): Cicero on interpreting omens. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius (speech 21)): Cassius's willingness to die. On setting: A violent storm with omens (a lion in the Capitol, men on fire, a bird of night at noon). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene III” treats storm, omens and recruitment with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “O, he sits high in all the people’s hearts” (Act I, Scene III, Casca (speech 36)): Casca on Brutus's reputation. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “men may construe things after their fashion, / Clean from the purpose of the things themselves” (Act I, Scene III, Cicero (speech 5)): Cicero on interpreting omens. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about storm, omens and recruitment? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The storm scene shows that omens can be interpreted however people wish. Useful evidence: “Cassius from bondage will deliver Cassius” (Act I, Scene III, Cassius (speech 21)): Cassius's willingness to die. Theme link: each character reads the omens to suit himself. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)

- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz

1. What strange sight does Casca report about a slave's hand?
   A. It burned but was not scorched
   B. It held a crown
   C. It bled
   D. It turned to stone
2. Which wild animal does Casca say he met near the Capitol?
   A. A wolf
   B. A bear
   C. A lion
   D. A boar
3. How does Cassius interpret the storm?
   A. As meaningless
   B. As a sign Caesar should be crowned
   C. As a curse on Cassius
   D. As a warning against Caesar's tyranny
4. Who is sent to place the letters for Brutus?
   A. Decius
   B. Trebonius
   C. Cinna
   D. Casca
5. Why do the conspirators want Brutus to join them?
   A. He has money
   B. He is the best soldier
   C. He is Caesar's son
   D. His good reputation will make the deed seem worthy
6. In the line “So can I: So every bondman in his own hand bears The power to cancel his captivity.”, what does “bondman” most nearly mean?
   A. a slave
   B. the supposed art of turning base metal to gold
   C. to interpret; to explain
   D. make lighter or brighter
7. In the line “Indeed, it is a strange-disposed time: But men may construe things after their fashion, Clean from the purpose of the things themselves.”, what does “construe” most nearly mean?
   A. a slave
   B. the supposed art of turning base metal to gold

C. make lighter or brighter

D. to interpret; to explain

Answer key: 1. A (It burned but was not scorched); 2. C (A lion); 3. D (As a warning against Caesar's tyranny); 4. C (Cinna); 5. D (His good reputation will make the deed seem worthy); 6. A (a slave); 7. D (to interpret; to explain)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act I, Scene III," how does Shakespeare show storm, omens and recruitment? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act I, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of storm, omens and recruitment? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of storm, omens and recruitment. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of storm, omens and recruitment. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene III suggests about storm, omens and recruitment. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act I, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of storm, omens and recruitment. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of storm, omens and recruitment responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of storm, omens and

recruitment follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene III and its treatment of storm, omens and recruitment. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about storm, omens and recruitment in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of storm, omens and recruitment. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Those that with haste will make a mighty fire Begin it with weak straws: what trash is Rome, What rubbish and what offal, when it serves For the base matter to illuminate So vile a thing as Caesar!*

   As used in the text, what does the word “illuminate” most nearly mean?

   A. to cut the limbs from a body

   B. make lighter or brighter

   C. understood; judged (well conceited: rightly grasped)

   D. married; having a husband

2. *A common slave—you know him well by sight— Held up his left hand, which did flame and burn Like twenty torches join’d, and yet his hand, Not sensible of fire, remain’d unscorch’d. Besides—I ha’ not since put up my sword— Against the Capitol I met a lion, Who glared upon me, and went surly by, Without annoying me: and there were drawn Upon a heap a hundred ghastly women, Transformed with their fear; who swore they saw Men all in fire walk up and down the streets. And yesterday the bird of night did sit Even at noon-day upon the market-place, Hooting and shrieking. When these prodigies Do so conjointly meet, let not men say “These are their reasons; they are natural;” For, I believe, they are portentous things Unto the climate that they point upon.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene III”?

   A. Parley before battle

   B. Cinna the poet

   C. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

   D. Storm, omens and recruitment

SAT key: 1. B (make lighter or brighter); 2. D (Storm, omens and recruitment)

Lesson 6: Act II, Scene I

Focus: Brutus decides

Teacher only · spoilers

Alone in his orchard at night, Brutus decides Caesar must die, not for what he has done but for what he might become: 'think him as a serpent's egg.' He reads a forged letter urging him to act. The conspirators arrive; Brutus refuses an oath, refuses to include Cicero, and overrules Cassius's plan to kill Antony too: 'Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers.' Decius promises to bring Caesar to the Capitol. Portia, who has wounded her own thigh to prove her constancy, demands to share his secret. Ligarius, though sick, joins.

Background: Brutus's ancestor, Lucius Junius Brutus, was said to have driven out Rome's last king, Tarquin, and founded the republic. That family history weighs on Brutus.

Significance: Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to honour and idealism because....
Prompt: Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to honour and idealism because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: husbanded — married; having a husband; dismember — to cut the limbs from a body; unbraced — with clothing unfastened; appertain — to belong to or be connected with; discard — to reject; to throw away.
“discard”: dis- "away" + card (playing card): originally "to throw a card out of one's hand," then "to cast off."
Words: husbanded: married; having a husband · dismember: to cut the limbs from a body · unbraced: with clothing unfastened · appertain: to belong to or be connected with · discard: to reject; to throw away

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Brutus's ancestor, Lucius Junius Brutus, was said to have driven out Rome's last king, Tarquin, and founded the republic. That family history weighs on Brutus. Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy. Soliloquy: "It must be by his death": Brutus decides to kill Caesar not for what he has done but for what he might become ("think him as a serpent's egg"). Characterization: Brutus overrules Cassius three times (no oath, spare Antony, let Antony speak later); Portia demands to share his secret. Imagery: The serpent's egg; "Let's carve him as a dish fit for the gods." Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "sir. / Searching the window for a flint, I found / This paper, thus seal'd up; and, I am sure, / It did not lie" (Act II, Scene I, Lucius (speech 6)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It must be by his death" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)). Brutus's decision. That is soliloquy at work: "It must be by his death": Brutus decides to kill Caesar not for what he has done but for what he might become ("think him as a serpent's egg").

> *It must be by his death (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It must be by his death" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)). Brutus's decision. That is soliloquy at work: "It must be by his death": Brutus decides to kill Caesar not for what he has done but for what he might become ("think him as a serpent's egg").

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The serpent's egg is a metaphor for potential danger: Caesar is to be judged on what he might do. Honour and idealism. Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism? Expected: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." (Preventive reasoning.)

> *And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The serpent's egg is a metaphor for potential danger: Caesar is to be judged on what he might do. Honour and idealism.
Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism?
Expected answer: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." (Preventive reasoning.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Brutus decides? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Brutus decides. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. When the text says "And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)), it shows this directly. He admits he has no evidence of present tyranny but asks the conspirators to "think him as a serpent's egg" and kill him "in the shell," and he wants them to be "sacrificers, but not butchers."

Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Brutus decides? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Brutus decides. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. When the text says "And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)), it shows this directly. He admits he has no evidence of present tyranny but asks the conspirators to "think him as a serpent's egg" and kill him "in the shell," and he wants them to be "sacrificers, but not butchers."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future? Ask: is preventive killing ever justified? Push for evidence from Brutus's own words.

Anchor question: Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future?

Facilitation: Ask: is preventive killing ever justified? Push for evidence from Brutus's own words.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Brutus decides? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. ("And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell", Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Brutus decides? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. ("And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell", Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how soliloquy shapes Brutus decides. Key takeaway: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** "It must be by his death": Brutus decides to kill Caesar not for what he has done but for what he might become ("think him as a serpent's egg").
- **Characterization:** Brutus overrules Cassius three times (no oath, spare Antony, let Antony speak later); Portia demands to share his secret.
- **Imagery:** The serpent's egg; "Let's carve him as a dish fit for the gods."

Themes and how they develop

- **honour and idealism:** Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers."

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "sir. / Searching the window for a flint, I found / This paper, thus seal'd up; and, I am sure, / It did not lie" (Act II, Scene I, Lucius (speech 6)).
- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "again; it is not day. / Is not to-morrow, boy, the ides of March" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 7)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "It must be by his death" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)) Brutus's decision.
- "And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)) Preventive reasoning.
- "Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 45)) Brutus's idealism.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning.
Evidence: "And therefore think him as a serpent's egg / Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5))
Reasoning: He admits he has no evidence of present tyranny but asks the conspirators to "think him as a serpent's egg" and kill him "in the shell," and he wants them to be "sacrificers, but not butchers."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
husbanded (adjective)	married; having a husband	*Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father'd and so husbanded?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dismember (verb)	to cut the limbs from a body	*We all stand up against the spirit of Caesar; And in the spirit of men there is no blood: O, that we then could come by Caesar's spirit, And not dismember Caesar!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unbraced (adjective)	with clothing unfastened	*Is Brutus sick? and is it physical To walk unbraced and suck up the humours Of the dank morning?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
appertain (verb)	to belong to or be connected with	*Within the bond of marriage, tell me, Brutus, Is it excepted I should know no secrets That appertain to you?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
discard (verb)	to reject; to throw away	*By all the gods that Romans bow before, I here discard my sickness!*	"discard": dis- "away" + card (playing card): originally "to throw a card out of one's hand," then "to cast off." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/discard)
prevention (noun)	being stopped before acting	*Seek none, conspiracy; Hide it in smiles and affability: For if thou path, thy native semblance on, Not*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		Erebus itself were dim enough To hide thee from prevention.	
suburbs (noun)	outskirts; the edges of something	*Dwell I but in the suburbs Of your good pleasure?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
butchers (noun)	people who kill savagely	*Our course will seem too bloody, Caius Cassius, To cut the head off and then hack the limbs, Like wrath in death and envy afterwards; For Antony is but a limb of Caesar: Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conjured (verb)	summon into action or bring into existence, often as if by magic	*Thou, like an exorcist, hast conjured up My mortified spirit.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
interpose (verb)	be or come between	*What watchful cares do interpose themselves Betwixt your eyes and night?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate, omens and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whom did Brutus's ancestors drive from Rome, as he recalls while reading the letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Tarquin, Rome's last king.
2. To what does Brutus compare Caesar in his soliloquy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A serpent's egg
3. What does Brutus refuse to let the conspirators do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Swear an oath
4. Whom does Cassius want to kill along with Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Mark Antony

5. Who promises to bring Caesar to the Capitol? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Decius Brutus
6. How has Portia proved her constancy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: She gave herself a wound in the thigh
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Alone in his orchard at night, Brutus decides Caesar must die, not for what he has done but for what he might become: 'think him as a serpent's egg.' He reads a forged letter urging him to act. The conspirators arrive; Brutus refuses an oath, refuses to include Cicero, and overrules Cassius's plan to kill Antony too: 'Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers.' Decius promises to bring Caesar to…
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father'd and so husbanded?" What does "husbanded" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: husbanded: married; having a husband.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Brutus's admission that he has no quarrel with what Caesar has done reveal about his reasoning? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: His case rests on speculation about Caesar's future, not facts.
2. What does "Act II, Scene I" suggest about Brutus decides? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about Brutus decides? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: "It must be by his death" (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)): Brutus's decision. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Let 'em enter.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act II, Scene I", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Alone in his orchard at night, Brutus decides Caesar must die, not

for what he has done but for what he might become: 'think him as a serpent's egg.' He reads a forged letter urging him to act. The conspirators arrive; Brutus refuses an oath, refuses to include Cicero, and overrules Cassius's plan…

7. How does “Act II, Scene I” build on “Act I, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)): Preventive reasoning. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 45)): Brutus's idealism. On characterization: Brutus overrules Cassius three times (no oath, spare Antony, let Antony speak later); Portia demands to share his secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate, omens and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “It must be by his death” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)): Brutus's decision. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Brutus calls the killing a sacrifice, not a butchery. Can how you name an act change what it is? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Strong answers weigh rhetoric against the reality of violence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)): Preventive reasoning. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy.” How far

do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 45)): Brutus's idealism. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “It must be by his death” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)): Brutus's decision. On characterization: Brutus overrules Cassius three times (no oath, spare Antony, let Antony speak later); Portia demands to share his secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Brutus decides. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)): Preventive reasoning. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 45)): Brutus's idealism. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to power, ambition and tyranny: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “It must be by his death” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)): Brutus's decision. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)): Preventive reasoning. On characterization: Brutus overrules Cassius three times (no oath, spare Antony, let Antony speak later); Portia demands to share his secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene I” treats Brutus decides with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 45)): Brutus's idealism. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “It must be by his death” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)): Brutus's decision. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Brutus decides? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus decides to kill Caesar on the basis of what Caesar might become, which shows both his idealism and the weakness of his reasoning. Useful evidence: “And therefore think him as a serpent’s egg / Which, hatch’d, would, as his kind, grow mischievous, / And kill him in the shell” (Act II, Scene I, Brutus (speech 5)): Preventive reasoning. Theme link: Brutus wants a clean, almost ritual killing: "sacrificers, but not butchers." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz

1. To what does Brutus compare Caesar in his soliloquy?

   A. A serpent's egg

   B. A lion

C. A falling star

D. A storm

2. What does Brutus refuse to let the conspirators do?

A. Meet at night

B. Swear an oath

C. Carry daggers

D. Speak to Portia

3. Whom does Cassius want to kill along with Caesar?

A. Lepidus

B. Mark Antony

C. Octavius

D. Cicero

4. Who promises to bring Caesar to the Capitol?

A. Decius Brutus

B. Casca

C. Cinna

D. Metellus

5. How has Portia proved her constancy?

A. She fasted for a week

B. She spied on Caesar

C. She gave herself a wound in the thigh

D. She swore an oath

6. In the line "Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father'd and so husbanded?", what does "husbanded" most nearly mean?

A. with clothing unfastened

B. married; having a husband

C. to cut the limbs from a body

D. to belong to or be connected with

7. In the line "We all stand up against the spirit of Caesar; And in the spirit of men there is no blood: O, that we then could come by Caesar's spirit, And not dismember Caesar!", what does "dismember" most nearly mean?

A. married; having a husband

B. to belong to or be connected with

C. with clothing unfastened

D. to cut the limbs from a body

Answer key: 1. A (A serpent's egg); 2. B (Swear an oath); 3. B (Mark Antony); 4. A (Decius Brutus); 5. C (She gave herself a wound in the thigh); 6. B (married; having a husband); 7. D (to cut the limbs from a body)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act II, Scene I," how does Shakespeare show Brutus decides? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Brutus decides? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Brutus decides. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Brutus decides. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene I suggests about Brutus decides. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of Brutus decides. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Brutus decides responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Brutus decides follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene I and its treatment of Brutus decides. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about Brutus decides in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Brutus decides. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Is Brutus sick? and is it physical To walk unbraced and suck up the humours Of the dank morning?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "unbraced" most nearly mean?

   A. be or come between

   B. summon into action or bring into existence, often as if by magic

   C. people who kill savagely

   D. with clothing unfastened

2. *Let 'em enter. Exit Lucius. They are the faction. O conspiracy, Shamest thou to show thy dangerous brow by night, When evils are most free? O, then by day Where wilt thou find a cavern dark enough To mask thy monstrous visage? Seek none, conspiracy; Hide it in smiles and affability: For if thou path, thy native semblance on, Not Erebus itself were dim enough To hide thee from prevention.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene I"?

   A. The first charge

   B. Brutus decides

   C. Cinna the poet

   D. The death of Brutus

SAT key: 1. D (with clothing unfastened); 2. B (Brutus decides)

Lesson 7: Act II, Scene II

Focus: Calpurnia's dream

Teacher only · spoilers

Calpurnia has dreamed of Caesar's statue spouting blood while Romans bathed their hands in it, and begs him to stay home. The augurs find no heart in a sacrificed beast. Caesar first boasts that danger knows he is more dangerous than it, then agrees to stay. Decius reinterprets the dream as Rome drawing life from Caesar, and says the Senate means to crown him and will mock him if he stays for a wife's dreams. Caesar goes; the conspirators and Antony arrive to escort him.

Background: Augurs were Roman priests who read the will of the gods in sacrifices and the flight of birds.

Significance: Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because....*
> **Prompt:** Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: predictions — statements about what will happen; expounded — explained; interpreted; purposed — intended; entrails — internal organs (of a sacrificed animal); beggars — very poor people who ask for money.*
> **Words:** predictions: statements about what will happen · expounded: explained; interpreted · purposed: intended · entrails: internal organs (of a sacrificed animal) · beggars: very poor people who ask for money

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Augurs were Roman priests who read the will of the gods in sacrifices and the flight of birds. Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him. Characterization: Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation. Dramatic irony: The audience knows the conspirators' plan; Caesar welcomes them as friends. Rhetoric: Decius flatters Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak. Watch for omens and portents: Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "know: / Calpurnia here, my wife, stays me at home: / She dreamt to-night she saw my statua, / Which, like a fountain with an" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 20)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)). Caesar's courage or pride. That is characterization at work: Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation.

> *Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once* *(Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)). Caesar's courage or pride. That is characterization at work: Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Third-person speech shows Caesar treating himself as a public monument. Fate and omens. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens? Expected: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. (Third-person speech.)

> *Caesar shall go forth* *(Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 8))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Third-person speech shows Caesar treating himself as a public monument. Fate and omens.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens?
Expected answer: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. (Third-person speech.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Calpurnia's dream? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of Calpurnia's dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. When the text says "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)), it shows this directly. Decius says the dream is "all amiss interpreted," and Caesar, who calls himself "Caesar" in the third person, goes, insisting the valiant "never taste of death but once."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Calpurnia's dream? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of Calpurnia's dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. When the text says "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)), it shows this directly. Decius says the dream is "all amiss interpreted," and Caesar, who calls himself "Caesar" in the third person, goes, insisting the valiant "never taste of death but once."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared? Ask: is Caesar brave or arrogant?
Anchor question: Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared?
Facilitation: Ask: is Caesar brave or arrogant?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Calpurnia's dream? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. ("Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once", Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Calpurnia's dream? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. ("Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once", Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Calpurnia's dream. Key takeaway: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation.
- **Dramatic irony:** The audience knows the conspirators' plan; Caesar welcomes them as friends.
- **Rhetoric:** Decius flatters Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** Caesar ignores the omens out of pride.

Symbols and motifs

- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: “know: / Calpurnia here, my wife, stays me at home: / She dreamt to-night she saw my statua, / Which, like a fountain with an” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 20)).
- **blood:** Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: “ranks and squadrons and right form of war, / Which drizzled blood upon the Capitol; / The noise of battle hurtled in the air” (Act II, Scene II, Calpurnia (speech 7)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)) Caesar's courage or pride.
- “Caesar shall go forth” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 8)) Third-person speech.
- “This dream is all amiss interpreted” (Act II, Scene II, Decius (speech 21)) Decius's flattery.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings.
Evidence: “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10))
Reasoning: Decius says the dream is "all amiss interpreted," and Caesar, who calls himself "Caesar" in the third person, goes, insisting the valiant "never taste of death but once."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

predictions (noun)	statements about what will happen	*Yet Caesar shall go forth; for these predictions Are to the world in general as to Caesar.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
expounded (verb)	explained; interpreted	*And this way have you well expounded it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
purposed (verb)	intended	*What can be avoided Whose end is purposed by the mighty gods?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
entrails (noun)	internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)	*Plucking the entrails of an offering forth, They could not find a heart within the beast.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
beggars (noun)	very poor people who ask for money	*When beggars die, there are no comets seen; The heavens themselves blaze forth the death of princes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
signified (verb)	meant; shown	*This by Calpurnia's dream is signified.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cowardice (noun)	lack of courage	*The gods do this in shame of cowardice: Caesar should be a beast without a heart, If he should stay at home to-day for fear.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wonders (noun)	the feeling aroused by something strange and surprising	*Of all the wonders that I yet have heard, It seems to me most strange that men should fear; Seeing that death, a necessary end, Will come when it will come.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What famous line does Caesar speak about cowards and death? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Cowards die many times before their deaths; the valiant taste death once.

2. What did Calpurnia dream about Caesar's statue? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It spouted blood that Romans bathed in
3. What do the augurs find in the sacrificed animal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: No heart
4. How does Decius reinterpret the dream? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Rome will draw reviving blood from Caesar
5. What does Decius say the Senate plans to give Caesar? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A crown
6. Why does Caesar change his mind and go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He fears being mocked for heeding a wife's dream
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Calpurnia has dreamed of Caesar's statue spouting blood while Romans bathed their hands in it, and begs him to stay home. The augurs find no heart in a sacrificed beast. Caesar first boasts that danger knows he is more dangerous than it, then agrees to stay. Decius reinterprets the dream as Rome drawing life from Caesar, and says the Senate means to crown him and will mock him if he stays for a…
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Yet Caesar shall go forth; for these predictions Are to the world in general as to Caesar." What does "predictions" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: predictions: statements about what will happen.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Caesar speak of himself in the third person ('Caesar shall go forth')? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: He treats himself as a public monument; it shows pride and self-image.
2. What does "Act II, Scene II" suggest about Calpurnia's dream? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about Calpurnia's dream? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)): Caesar's courage or pride. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Cowards die many times before their deaths; The valiant never taste of death but once.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Calpurnia has dreamed of Caesar's statue spouting blood while Romans bathed their hands in it, and begs him to stay home. The augurs find no heart in a sacrificed beast. Caesar first boasts that danger knows he is more dangerous than it, then agrees to stay. Decius reinterprets the dream as Rome…
7. How does “Act II, Scene II” build on “Act II, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Caesar shall go forth” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 8)): Third-person speech. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “This dream is all amiss interpreted” (Act II, Scene II, Decius (speech 21)): Decius's flattery. On characterization: Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)): Caesar's courage or pride. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Which matters more in Caesar's decision: pride or fate? Argue with evidence from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Decius's appeal to pride is decisive, though omens foreshadow fate.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Caesar shall go forth” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 8)): Third-person speech. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “This dream is all amiss interpreted” (Act II, Scene II, Decius (speech 21)): Decius's flattery. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)): Caesar's courage or pride. On characterization: Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Calpurnia's dream. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Caesar shall go forth” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 8)): Third-person speech. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “This dream is all amiss interpreted” (Act II, Scene II, Decius (speech 21)): Decius's flattery. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)): Caesar's courage or pride. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: “Caesar shall go forth” (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 8)): Third-person

speech. On characterization: Calpurnia's dream of Caesar's statue spouting blood; Caesar decides to stay, then is persuaded by Decius's flattering reinterpretation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act II, Scene II" treats Calpurnia's dream with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: "This dream is all amiss interpreted" (Act II, Scene II, Decius (speech 21)): Decius's flattery. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act II, Scene III" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: "Cowards die many times before their deaths; / The valiant never taste of death but once" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 10)): Caesar's courage or pride. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Calpurnia's dream? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Caesar's pride in his public image leads him to ignore warnings. Useful evidence: "Caesar shall go forth" (Act II, Scene II, Caesar (speech 8)): Third-person speech. Theme link: Caesar ignores the omens out of pride. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz

1. What did Calpurnia dream about Caesar's statue?

   A. It spouted blood that Romans bathed in

   B. It wept

   C. It turned to gold

   D. It fell and broke

2. What do the augurs find in the sacrificed animal?

   A. No heart

   B. Two hearts

   C. A snake

D. A coin

3. How does Decius reinterpret the dream?
   A. Rome will draw reviving blood from Caesar
   B. Calpurnia is jealous
   C. Caesar will die soon
   D. The gods are angry
4. What does Decius say the Senate plans to give Caesar?
   A. A crown
   B. A triumph
   C. An army
   D. A temple
5. Why does Caesar change his mind and go?
   A. Antony insists
   B. The augurs approve
   C. He fears being mocked for heeding a wife's dream
   D. Calpurnia changes her mind
6. In the line "Yet Caesar shall go forth; for these predictions Are to the world in general as to Caesar.", what does "predictions" most nearly mean?
   A. intended
   B. internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)
   C. explained; interpreted
   D. statements about what will happen
7. In the line "And this way have you well expounded it.", what does "expounded" most nearly mean?
   A. intended
   B. statements about what will happen
   C. explained; interpreted
   D. internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)

Answer key: 1. A (It spouted blood that Romans bathed in); 2. A (No heart); 3. A (Rome will draw reviving blood from Caesar); 4. A (A crown); 5. C (He fears being mocked for heeding a wife's dream); 6. D (statements about what will happen); 7. C (explained; interpreted)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act II, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show Calpurnia's dream? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Calpurnia's dream? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of Calpurnia's dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Calpurnia's dream. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene II suggests about Calpurnia's dream. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Calpurnia's dream. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Calpurnia's dream responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Calpurnia's dream follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene II and its treatment of Calpurnia's dream. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Calpurnia's dream in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Calpurnia's dream. Position your reading

within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *What can be avoided Whose end is purposed by the mighty gods?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "purposed" most nearly mean?

   A. meant; shown

   B. intended

   C. lack of courage

   D. the feeling aroused by something strange and surprising

2. *Cowards die many times before their deaths; The valiant never taste of death but once. Of all the wonders that I yet have heard, It seems to me most strange that men should fear; Seeing that death, a necessary end, Will come when it will come.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene II"?

   A. Calpurnia's dream

   B. The funeral orations

   C. Artemidorus's letter

   D. The assassination

SAT key: 1. B (intended); 2. A (Calpurnia's dream)

Lesson 8: Act II, Scene III

Focus: Artemidorus's letter

Teacher only · spoilers

Artemidorus, a teacher of rhetoric, reads aloud a letter he has written naming the conspirators and warning Caesar to look about him. He plans to stand in the street and hand it to Caesar on the way to the Capitol, lamenting that virtue cannot live out of reach of envy.

Background: This very short scene (Act II, Scene III) builds suspense just before the assassination. Plutarch reports that a man named Artemidorus tried to warn Caesar.

Significance: The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because....
Prompt: Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: one more warning that fails.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: emulation — envious rivalry; laments — grieves; contrive — to plot; befriend — to help; to favor; commend — to send greetings; to recommend.
Words: emulation: envious rivalry · laments: grieves · contrive: to plot · befriend: to help; to favor · commend: to send greetings; to recommend

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
This very short scene (Act II, Scene III) builds suspense just before the assassination. Plutarch reports that a man named Artemidorus tried to warn Caesar. The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable. Structure: Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience. Dramatic irony: We know he will not be heard. Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Enter Artemidorus, reading a paper" (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 0)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius" (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus (speech 1)). The letter. That is structure at work: Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience.

> *Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius* (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus (speech 1))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius" (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus (speech 1)). The letter. That is structure at work: Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Emulation" here means envy. The line suggests the conspiracy is driven by envy, not virtue. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens? Expected: One more warning that fails. (Envy kills virtue.)

> *My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation* (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Emulation" here means envy. The line suggests the conspiracy is driven by envy, not virtue.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens?
Expected answer: One more warning that fails. (Envy kills virtue.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for structure, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Artemidorus's letter? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Artemidorus's letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. When the text says "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live" (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)), it shows this directly. "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live," he says, and the audience knows Caesar will not read it.
Task: Annotate the scene for structure, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Artemidorus's letter? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Artemidorus's letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. When the text says "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live" (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)), it shows this directly. "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live," he says, and the audience knows Caesar will not read it.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster? Ask: does Artemidorus's view of the conspirators match Brutus's?
Anchor question: Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster?
Facilitation: Ask: does Artemidorus's view of the conspirators match Brutus's?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Artemidorus's letter? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. ("If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live", Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Artemidorus's letter? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. ("If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live", Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes Artemidorus's letter. Key takeaway: one more warning that fails.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience.
- **Dramatic irony:** We know he will not be heard.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** one more warning that fails.

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: “Enter Artemidorus, reading a paper” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 0)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus (speech 1)) The letter.
- “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)) Artemidorus's hope.
- “My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)) Envy kills virtue.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved.
Evidence: “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1))
Reasoning: "If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live," he says, and the audience knows Caesar will not read it.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
emulation (noun)	envious rivalry	*My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
laments (verb)	grieves	*My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
contrive (verb)	to plot	*If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live; If not, the Fates with traitors do contrive.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
befriend (verb)	to help; to favor	*That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

commend (verb)	to send greetings; to recommend	*Run, Lucius, and commend me to my lord; Say I am merry: come to me again, And bring me word what he doth say to thee.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
suitors (noun)	people who bring a request	*Yes, bring me word, boy, if thy lord look well, For he went sickly forth: and take good note What Caesar doth, what suitors press to him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
beseech (verb)	to beg	*That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enterprise (noun)	a bold undertaking	*O Brutus, The heavens speed thee in thine enterprise!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster?
2. Where does structure appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which conspirators does Artemidorus name in his letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Cinna, Trebonius, Metellus Cimber, Decius Brutus and Ligarius.
2. What does Artemidorus's letter contain? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The names of the conspirators
3. Where does Artemidorus plan to give Caesar the letter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: In the street as Caesar passes
4. What is Artemidorus's profession? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A teacher of rhetoric
5. What does Artemidorus say about virtue? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It cannot live out of the teeth of emulation (envy)
6. What does the letter tell Caesar security gives way to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Conspiracy
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Artemidorus, a teacher of rhetoric, reads aloud a letter he has written naming the conspirators and warning Caesar to look about him. He plans to stand in the street and hand it to Caesar on the way to the Capitol, lamenting that virtue cannot live out of reach of envy.

8. Who is on stage in “Act II, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act II, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.” What does “emulation” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: emulation: envious rivalry.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the letter say 'If thou beest not immortal, look about you'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: It punctures Caesar's godlike self-image: he is mortal and must take care.
2. What does “Act II, Scene III” suggest about Artemidorus's letter? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable.
3. Find one example of structure in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about Artemidorus's letter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus (speech 1)): The letter. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Here will I stand till Caesar pass along, And as a suitor will I give him this.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Artemidorus, a teacher of rhetoric, reads aloud a letter he has written naming the conspirators and warning Caesar to look about him. He plans to stand in the street and hand it to Caesar on the way to the Capitol, lamenting that virtue cannot live out of reach of envy.
7. How does “Act II, Scene III” build on “Act II, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)): Artemidorus's hope. On structure: Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted

line.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)): Envy kills virtue. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus (speech 1)): The letter. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. If Caesar had read the letter, would the play's events have been different? What does this scene suggest about chance? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Accept arguments for chance, character, and fate.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)): Artemidorus's hope. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)): Envy kills virtue. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus (speech 1)): The letter. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Artemidorus's letter. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)): Artemidorus's hope. On structure: Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)): Envy kills virtue. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus (speech 1)): The letter. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the structure in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)): Artemidorus's hope. On structure: Artemidorus reads his warning letter to the audience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene III” treats Artemidorus's letter with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “My heart laments that virtue cannot live / Out of the teeth of emulation” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)): Envy kills virtue. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “Caesar, beware of Brutus; take heed of Cassius” (Act II, Scene III, Artemidorus (speech 1)): The letter. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Artemidorus's letter? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Artemidorus's letter heightens suspense by showing that Caesar could still be saved. Useful evidence: “If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live” (Act II, Scene III, speech (speech 1)): Artemidorus's hope. Theme link: one more warning that fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. What does Artemidorus's letter contain?
    A. A request for money
    B. The names of the conspirators
    C. A prophecy
    D. A love poem
2. Where does Artemidorus plan to give Caesar the letter?
    A. In the Senate
    B. At Caesar's house
    C. At the feast
    D. In the street as Caesar passes
3. What is Artemidorus's profession?
    A. A priest
    B. A teacher of rhetoric
    C. A senator
    D. A soldier
4. What does Artemidorus say about virtue?
    A. It always wins
    B. It is rare in Rome
    C. It cannot live out of the teeth of emulation (envy)

D. It is weakness

5. What does the letter tell Caesar security gives way to?
   A. Fortune
   B. Conspiracy
   C. Death
   D. Tyranny
6. In the line “My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.”, what does “emulation” most nearly mean?
   A. to help; to favor
   B. to plot
   C. envious rivalry
   D. grieves
7. In the line “My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.”, what does “laments” most nearly mean?
   A. to help; to favor
   B. grieves
   C. to plot
   D. envious rivalry

Answer key: 1. B (The names of the conspirators); 2. D (In the street as Caesar passes); 3. B (A teacher of rhetoric); 4. C (It cannot live out of the teeth of emulation (envy)); 5. B (Conspiracy); 6. C (envious rivalry); 7. B (grieves)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Artemidorus's letter? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Artemidorus's letter? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Artemidorus's letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of Artemidorus's letter. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene III suggests about Artemidorus's letter. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's structure and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses structure in Act II, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Artemidorus's letter. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Artemidorus's letter responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Artemidorus's letter follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene III and its treatment of Artemidorus's letter. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's structure and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Artemidorus's letter in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Artemidorus's letter. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live; If not, the Fates with traitors do contrive.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “contrive” most nearly mean?

   A. to beg

   B. people who bring a request

   C. a bold undertaking

   D. to plot

2. *Here will I stand till Caesar pass along, And as a suitor will I give him this. My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation. If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live; If not, the Fates with traitors do contrive. Exit.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene III"?

A. Storm, omens and recruitment

B. Artemidorus's letter

C. The funeral orations

D. Cassius works on Brutus

SAT key: 1. D (to plot); 2. B (Artemidorus's letter)

Lesson 9: Act II, Scene IV

Focus: Portia's anxiety

Teacher only · spoilers

Portia, nearly frantic with knowledge of the plot, sends the boy Lucius to the Senate house without being able to say why, then asks him to report how Brutus looks and who comes to Caesar. She questions the soothsayer, who plans to warn Caesar again from a narrow place in the street, and she nearly gives the secret away.

Background: Act II, Scene IV is the last scene before the assassination and the last time Portia appears on stage.

Significance: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to honour and idealism because....
Prompt: What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to honour and idealism because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: befriend — to help; to favor; commend — to send greetings; to recommend; suitors — people who bring a request; beseech — to beg; enterprise — a bold undertaking.
Words: befriend: to help; to favor · commend: to send greetings; to recommend · suitors: people who bring a request · beseech: to beg · enterprise: a bold undertaking

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Act II, Scene IV is the last scene before the assassination and the last time Portia appears on stage. Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV. Characterization: Portia's anxiety: she sends Lucius to the Capitol without an errand. Characterization: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it. Watch for omens and portents: Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "Enter the Soothsayer" (Act II, Scene IV, speech (speech 8)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)). Portia's frustration. That is characterization at work: Portia's anxiety: she sends Lucius to the Capitol without an errand.

> *I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might* (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)). Portia's frustration. That is characterization at work: Portia's anxiety: she sends Lucius to the Capitol without an errand.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Her self-criticism. Look at the craft: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it. Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism? Expected: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. (Her self-criticism.)

> *How hard it is for women to keep counsel* (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Her self-criticism. Look at the craft: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it.
Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism?
Expected answer: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. (Her self-criticism.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Portia's anxiety? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of Portia's anxiety. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. When the text says “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)), it shows this directly. She says "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might," wanting to act but unable.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Portia's anxiety? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of Portia's anxiety. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. When the text says “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)), it shows this directly. She says "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might," wanting to act but unable.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share? Ask: what does Portia's scene add to the play?
Anchor question: What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share?
Facilitation: Ask: what does Portia's scene add to the play?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Portia's anxiety? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. ("I have a man's mind, but a woman's might", Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Portia's anxiety? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. ("I have a man's mind, but a woman's might", Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Portia's anxiety. Key takeaway: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Portia's anxiety: she sends Lucius to the Capitol without an errand.
- **Characterization:** She knows the secret and struggles to hide it.

Themes and how they develop

- **honour and idealism:** Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets.

Symbols and motifs

- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "Enter the Soothsayer" (Act II, Scene IV, speech (speech 8)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might" (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)) Portia's frustration.
- "How hard it is for women to keep counsel" (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)) Her self-criticism.
- "Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is" (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 19)) Her fear.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause.
Evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3))
Reasoning: She says "I have a man's mind, but a woman's might," wanting to act but unable.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
befriend (verb)	to help; to favor	*That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
commend (verb)	to send greetings; to recommend	*Run, Lucius, and commend me to my lord; Say I am merry: come to me again, And bring me word what he doth say to thee.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
suitors (noun)	people who bring a request	*Yes, bring me word, boy, if thy lord look well, For he went sickly forth: and take good note What Caesar doth, what suitors press to him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
beseech (verb)	to beg	*That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enterprise (noun)	a bold undertaking	*O Brutus, The heavens speed thee in thine enterprise!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
purpled (adjective)	stained red with blood	*I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enfranchisement (noun)	restoration of a citizen's rights	*Pardon, Caesar; Caesar, pardon: As low as to thy foot doth Cassius fall, To beg enfranchisement for Publius Cimber.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
doomsday (noun)	the day of final judgment; the end of the world	*Fled to his house amazed: Men, wives and children stare, cry out and run As it were doomsday.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Portia ask Lucius to report back? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Whether Brutus looks well (he went out sickly), what Caesar does and who presses toward him.
2. Where does Portia send Lucius? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To the Senate house
3. Why can't Portia explain the errand to Lucius? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: She must not reveal the plot
4. Whom does Portia meet in the street? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The soothsayer
5. What does the soothsayer plan to do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Speak to Caesar as he passes
6. What does Portia say about a woman's heart? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It is weak
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Portia, nearly frantic with knowledge of the plot, sends the boy Lucius to the Senate house without being able to say why, then asks him to report how Brutus looks and who comes to Caesar. She questions the soothsayer, who plans to warn Caesar again from a narrow place in the street, and she nearly gives the secret away.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself." What does "befriend" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: befriend: to help; to favor.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Portia's behavior suggest about the burden Brutus has shared with her? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: The secret torments her; she can barely hide it.
2. What does "Act II, Scene IV" suggest about Portia's anxiety? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV.

3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about Portia's anxiety? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)): Portia's frustration. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “None that I know will be, much that I fear may chance.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Portia, nearly frantic with knowledge of the plot, sends the boy Lucius to the Senate house without being able to say why, then asks him to report how Brutus looks and who comes to Caesar. She questions the soothsayer, who plans to warn Caesar again from a narrow place in the street, and she nearly…
7. How does “Act II, Scene IV” build on “Act II, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)): Her self-criticism. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 19)): Her fear. On characterization: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)): Portia's frustration. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Portia calls a woman's heart weak, though she wounded herself to prove her strength. How do you read this contradiction? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Accept answers on period gender norms and on strain under pressure.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)): Her self-criticism. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 19)): Her fear. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)): Portia's frustration. On characterization: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Portia's anxiety. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)): Her self-criticism. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 19)): Her fear. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)): Portia's frustration. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)): Her self-criticism. On characterization: She knows the secret and struggles to hide it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene IV” treats Portia's anxiety with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “Ay me, how weak a thing / The heart of woman is” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 19)): Her fear. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “I have a man’s mind, but a woman’s might” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)): Portia's frustration. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Portia's anxiety? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of Brutus's public cause. Useful evidence: “How hard it is for women to keep counsel” (Act II, Scene IV, Portia (speech 3)): Her self-criticism. Theme link: Portia's suffering shows the cost of political secrets. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Where does Portia send Lucius?
   A. To the Senate house
   B. To Cassius's home
   C. To Antony
   D. To the market
2. Why can't Portia explain the errand to Lucius?
   A. She is ill
   B. She does not trust him
   C. She must not reveal the plot
   D. She has forgotten it
3. Whom does Portia meet in the street?
   A. The soothsayer
   B. Casca
   C. Artemidorus
   D. Calpurnia
4. What does the soothsayer plan to do?
   A. Join the conspirators
   B. Leave Rome
   C. Speak to Caesar as he passes
   D. Warn Brutus
5. What does Portia say about a woman's heart?
   A. It is weak
   B. It cannot love
   C. It is never afraid
   D. It is as strong as a man's
6. In the line “That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.”, what does “befriend” most nearly mean?
   A. to help; to favor
   B. to beg
   C. to send greetings; to recommend
   D. people who bring a request

7. In the line “Run, Lucius, and commend me to my lord; Say I am merry: come to me again, And bring me word what he doth say to thee.”, what does “commend” most nearly mean?
   A. to beg
   B. to help; to favor
   C. to send greetings; to recommend
   D. people who bring a request

Answer key: 1. A (To the Senate house); 2. C (She must not reveal the plot); 3. A (The soothsayer); 4. C (Speak to Caesar as he passes); 5. A (It is weak); 6. A (to help; to favor); 7. C (to send greetings; to recommend)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show Portia's anxiety? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act II, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Portia's anxiety? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of Portia's anxiety. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Portia's anxiety. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene IV suggests about Portia's anxiety. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of Portia's anxiety. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Portia's anxiety responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Portia's anxiety follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene IV and its treatment of Portia's anxiety. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about Portia's anxiety in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Portia's anxiety. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Yes, bring me word, boy, if thy lord look well, For he went sickly forth: and take good note What Caesar doth, what suitors press to him.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “suitors” most nearly mean?

   A. stained red with blood

   B. the day of final judgment; the end of the world

   C. restoration of a citizen's rights

   D. people who bring a request

2. *None that I know will be, much that I fear may chance. Good morrow to you. Here the street is narrow: The throng that follows Caesar at the heels, Of senators, of praetors, common suitors, Will crowd a feeble man almost to death: I’ll get me to a place more void, and there Speak to great Caesar as he comes along. Exit.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene IV”?

   A. The triumvirs' proscription list

   B. Cassius works on Brutus

   C. The assassination

   D. Portia's anxiety

SAT key: 1. D (people who bring a request); 2. D (Portia's anxiety)

Lesson 10: Act III, Scene I

Focus: the assassination

Content note (assassination, blood): Caesar is stabbed on stage and the conspirators bathe their hands in his blood. Focus on how each side names the act (sacrifice, murder, liberty).
Student preview: This scene shows a political killing on stage.
Suggested language: "Why do the conspirators want blood on their hands in public?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Caesar brushes aside the soothsayer ('the ides of March are come') and refuses to read Artemidorus's letter first. Trebonius draws Antony away. Metellus Cimber pleads for his banished brother; Caesar refuses, calling himself 'constant as the northern star.' Casca strikes first; the others stab; Brutus strikes last ('Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!'). The conspirators bathe their hands in Caesar's blood and cry liberty. Antony sends a servant, then comes himself, shakes their bloody hands and asks to speak at the funeral. Brutus agrees over Cassius's objection, on condition that Antony speaks after him and does not blame them. Alone, Antony prophesies civil war ('Cry Havoc, and let slip the dogs of war'). News comes that Octavius is near Rome.

Background: The real assassination took place on 15 March 44 BC in the Theatre of Pompey, where the Senate was meeting; Shakespeare sets it at the Capitol. The words 'Et tu, Brute?' come from earlier English tradition, not Plutarch.

Significance: The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to power and ambition because.... Content note before we start: This scene shows a political killing on stage.
Prompt: Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to power and ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: purpled — stained red with blood; enfranchisement — restoration of a citizen's rights; doomsday — the day of final judgment; the end of the world; pulpits — platforms for public speaking; abridged — shortened.
Words: purpled: stained red with blood · enfranchisement: restoration of a citizen's rights · doomsday: the day of final judgment; the end of the world · pulpits: platforms for public speaking · abridged: shortened

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The real assassination took place on 15 March 44 BC in the Theatre of Pompey, where the Senate was meeting; Shakespeare sets it at the Capitol. The words 'Et tu, Brute?' come from earlier English tradition, not Plutarch. The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge. Characterization: Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!" Structure: The assassination is the play's centre; afterwards Brutus mistakes Antony's grief for a negotiation and lets him speak at the funeral. Soliloquy: Alone with the body, Antony prophesies "Cry 'Havoc,' and let slip the dogs of war." Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "He did receive his letters, and is coming; / And bid me say to you by word" (Act III, Scene I, Servant (speech 86)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "But I am constant as the northern star" (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 30)). Caesar's hubris just before his death. That is characterization at work: Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!"

> *But I am constant as the northern star (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 30))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "But I am constant as the northern star" (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 30)). Caesar's hubris just before his death. That is characterization at work: Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!"

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Havoc" was the order for soldiers to loot and kill without mercy; "dogs of war" personifies war as hounds. The assassination has unleashed chaos. Expected link: power and ambition. Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition? Expected: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." (Antony's prophecy of civil war.)

> *Cry "Havoc," and let slip the dogs of war (Act III, Scene I, Antony (speech 83))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Havoc" was the order for soldiers to loot and kill without mercy; "dogs of war" personifies war as hounds. The assassination has unleashed chaos. Expected link: power and ambition.
Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition?
Expected answer: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." (Antony's prophecy of civil war.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the assassination? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of the assassination. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. When the text says "Cry "Havoc," and let slip the dogs of war" (Act III, Scene I, Antony (speech 83)), it shows this directly. Caesar dies with "Et tu, Brute?", making Brutus's betrayal the deepest wound, and as soon as Antony is alone he vows to "let slip the dogs of war," the opposite of the peace Brutus hoped for.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the assassination? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of the assassination. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. When the text says "Cry "Havoc," and let slip the dogs of war" (Act III, Scene I, Antony (speech 83)), it shows this directly. Caesar dies with "Et tu, Brute?", making Brutus's betrayal the deepest wound, and as soon as Antony is alone he vows to "let slip the dogs of war," the opposite of the peace Brutus hoped for.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end? Ask: was Brutus right to let Antony speak? Use Cassius's objection.

Anchor question: Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end?

Facilitation: Ask: was Brutus right to let Antony speak? Use Cassius's objection.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the assassination? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. ("Cry "Havoc," and let slip the dogs of war", Act III, Scene I, Antony (speech 83)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the assassination? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. ("Cry "Havoc," and let slip the dogs of war", Act III, Scene I, Antony (speech 83)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the assassination. Key takeaway: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star."*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!"
- **Structure:** The assassination is the play's centre; afterwards Brutus mistakes Antony's grief for a negotiation and lets him speak at the funeral.
- **Soliloquy:** Alone with the body, Antony prophesies "Cry 'Havoc,' and let slip the dogs of war."

Themes and how they develop

- **power and ambition:** Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star."

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: “He did receive his letters, and is coming; / And bid me say to you by word” (Act III, Scene I, Servant (speech 86)).
- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: “A crowd of people; among them Artemidorus and the Soothsayer. Flourish. Enter Caesar, Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Decius, Metellus, Trebonius, Cinna, Antony” (Act III, Scene I, speech (speech 0)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 30)) Caesar's hubris just before his death.
- “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 36)) His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history).
- “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony (speech 83)) Antony's prophecy of civil war.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph.
> **Evidence:** “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony (speech 83))

Reasoning: Caesar dies with "Et tu, Brute?", making Brutus's betrayal the deepest wound, and as soon as Antony is alone he vows to "let slip the dogs of war," the opposite of the peace Brutus hoped for.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
purpled (adjective)	stained red with blood	*I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enfranchisement (noun)	restoration of a citizen's rights	*Pardon, Caesar; Caesar, pardon: As low as to thy foot doth Cassius fall, To beg enfranchisement for Publius Cimber.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
doomsday (noun)	the day of final judgment; the end of the world	*Fled to his house amazed: Men, wives and children stare, cry out and run As it were doomsday.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pulpits (noun)	platforms for public speaking	*Some to the common pulpits, and cry out "Liberty, freedom, and enfranchisement!"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
abridged (verb)	shortened	*Grant that, and then is death a benefit: So are we Caesar's friends, that have abridged His time of fearing death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
besmear (verb)	to smear all over	*Stoop, Romans, stoop, And let us bathe our hands in Caesar's blood Up to the elbows, and besmear our swords: Then walk we forth, even to the market-place, And, waving our red weapons o'er our heads, Let's all cry "Peace, freedom and liberty!"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
fawning (verb)	flattering like a dog	*Be not fond, To think that Caesar bears such rebel blood That will be thaw'd from the true quality With that which melteth fools; I mean, sweet words, Low-crooked court'sies and base spaniel-fawning.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
proclaim (verb)	to declare publicly	*Run hence, proclaim, cry it about the streets.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
funeral (noun)	a ceremony for a dead person	*That's all I seek: And am moreover suitor that I may Produce his body to the market-place; And in the pulpit, as becomes a friend, Speak in the order of his funeral.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
prevention (noun)	being stopped before acting	*Casca, be sudden, for we fear prevention.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end?

2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who draws Antony away before the attack? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Trebonius.
2. Who strikes Caesar first? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Casca
3. To what does Caesar compare himself just before the attack? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The northern star
4. Whose banished brother does Metellus Cimber plead for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His own
5. What condition does Brutus set on Antony's funeral speech? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He must speak after Brutus and not blame the conspirators
6. What does Antony predict in his soliloquy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Civil war
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act III, Scene I” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Caesar brushes aside the soothsayer ('the ides of March are come') and refuses to read Artemidorus's letter first. Trebonius draws Antony away. Metellus Cimber pleads for his banished brother; Caesar refuses, calling himself 'constant as the northern star.' Casca strikes first; the others stab; Brutus strikes last ('Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!'). The conspirators bathe their hands in…
8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene I”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure.” What does “purpled” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: purpled: stained red with blood.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Antony shake each conspirator's bloody hand? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: To appear reconciled and win the chance to speak at the funeral.

2. What does “Act III, Scene I” suggest about the assassination? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the assassination? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 30)): Caesar's hubris just before his death. On characterization: Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “I must prevent thee, Cimber.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Caesar brushes aside the soothsayer ('the ides of March are come') and refuses to read Artemidorus's letter first. Trebonius draws Antony away. Metellus Cimber pleads for his banished brother; Caesar refuses, calling himself 'constant as the northern star.' Casca strikes first; the others stab;…
7. How does “Act III, Scene I” build on “Act II, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 36)): His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history). On structure: The assassination is the play's centre; afterwards Brutus mistakes Antony's grief for a negotiation and lets him speak at the funeral. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony (speech 83)): Antony's prophecy of civil war. On characterization: Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 30)): Caesar's hubris just before his death. On structure: The assassination is the play's centre; afterwards Brutus mistakes Antony's grief for a negotiation and lets him speak at the funeral. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Cassius predicts letting Antony speak is a mistake. Was Brutus's decision noble, naive, or both? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Strong answers weigh Brutus's honor against political judgment.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 36)): His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history). Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony (speech 83)): Antony's prophecy of civil war. Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 30)): Caesar's hubris just before his death. On characterization: Caesar compares himself to the "northern star," refusing a petition moments before he is stabbed; "Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the assassination. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 36)): His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history). On structure: The assassination is the play's centre; afterwards Brutus mistakes Antony's grief for a negotiation and lets him speak at the

funeral. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony (speech 83)): Antony's prophecy of civil war. Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 30)): Caesar's hubris just before his death. Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 36)): His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history). Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene I” treats the assassination with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Cry “Havoc,” and let slip the dogs of war” (Act III, Scene I, Antony (speech 83)): Antony's prophecy of civil war. Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “But I am constant as the northern star” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 30)): Caesar's hubris just before his death. Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the assassination? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The assassination scene shows Brutus's idealism failing at the moment of its triumph. Useful evidence: “Et tu, Brute! Then fall, Caesar” (Act III, Scene I, Caesar (speech 36)): His last words in the play (see the intro flag on their history). Theme link: Caesar's final speech is his most arrogant: he claims to be "constant as the northern star." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz

1. Who strikes Caesar first?
   A. Casca
   B. Brutus
   C. Cassius
   D. Cinna
2. To what does Caesar compare himself just before the attack?
   A. The sun
   B. A lion
   C. A mountain
   D. The northern star
3. Whose banished brother does Metellus Cimber plead for?
   A. Cicero's
   B. Antony's
   C. Brutus's
   D. His own
4. What condition does Brutus set on Antony's funeral speech?
   A. He must speak first
   B. He must speak in Greek
   C. He must speak after Brutus and not blame the conspirators
   D. He must not mention Caesar
5. What does Antony predict in his soliloquy?
   A. Civil war
   B. A new king
   C. Peace

D. Brutus's coronation

6. In the line “I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure.”, what does “purpled” most nearly mean?
   A. stained red with blood
   B. the day of final judgment; the end of the world
   C. restoration of a citizen's rights
   D. platforms for public speaking
7. In the line “Pardon, Caesar; Caesar, pardon: As low as to thy foot doth Cassius fall, To beg enfranchisement for Publius Cimber.”, what does “enfranchisement” most nearly mean?
   A. the day of final judgment; the end of the world
   B. restoration of a citizen's rights
   C. stained red with blood
   D. platforms for public speaking

Answer key: 1. A (Casca); 2. D (The northern star); 3. D (His own); 4. C (He must speak after Brutus and not blame the conspirators); 5. A (Civil war); 6. A (stained red with blood); 7. B (restoration of a citizen's rights)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the assassination? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the assassination? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of the assassination. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the assassination. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene I suggests about the assassination. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act III, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the

assassination. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the assassination responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the assassination follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene I and its treatment of the assassination. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the assassination in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the assassination. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Fled to his house amazed: Men, wives and children stare, cry out and run As it were doomsday.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “doomsday” most nearly mean?

   A. to declare publicly

   B. being stopped before acting

   C. a ceremony for a dead person

   D. the day of final judgment; the end of the world

2. *I must prevent thee, Cimber. These couchings and these lowly courtesies Might fire the blood of ordinary men, And turn pre-ordinance and first decree Into the law of children. Be not fond, To think that Caesar bears such rebel blood That will be thaw’d from the true quality With that which melteth fools; I mean, sweet words, Low-crooked court’sies and base spaniel-fawning. Thy brother by decree is banished: If thou dost bend and pray and fawn for him, I spurn thee like a cur out of my way. Know, Caesar doth not wrong, nor without cause Will he be satisfied.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene I”?

   A. Young Cato and Lucilius

B. Portia's anxiety

C. Cassius works on Brutus

D. The assassination

SAT key: 1. D (the day of final judgment; the end of the world); 2. D (The assassination)

Lesson 11: Act III, Scene II

Focus: the funeral orations

Teacher only · spoilers

Brutus speaks to the plebeians in prose: he loved Caesar, but loved Rome more; Caesar was ambitious, so he killed him. The crowd cheers and even shouts to make Brutus Caesar. Brutus leaves Antony to speak. Antony, in verse, repeats that 'Brutus is an honourable man' until the phrase turns to irony; recalls Caesar refusing the crown; weeps; shows the torn, bloody mantle; and finally reads Caesar's will, which leaves every citizen seventy-five drachmas and his private gardens. The crowd riots to burn the conspirators' houses. Antony hears Octavius is in Rome and that Brutus and Cassius have fled.

Background: Roman funeral orations (laudationes) praised the dead in public. Rhetoric, the study of persuasion, was central to Roman and Elizabethan education; students practiced ethos, pathos and logos.

Significance: This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because....
Prompt: Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: extenuated — played down; made to seem less; withholds — holds back; ransoms — payments to free captives; drachmas — silver coins; disprove — to show to be false.
Words: extenuated: played down; made to seem less · withholds: holds back · ransoms: payments to free captives · drachmas: silver coins · disprove: to show to be false

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Roman funeral orations (laudationes) praised the dead in public. Rhetoric, the study of persuasion, was central to Roman and Elizabethan education; students practiced ethos, pathos and logos. This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence. Rhetoric: Brutus's speech is in prose, logical and restrained ("Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more"); Antony's is verse, emotional, ironic and dramatic, with the will and the body as props. Irony: Antony's repeated "Brutus is an honourable man" turns praise into accusation. Structure: The crowd's lines show their shifts in real time. Watch for honour: "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “be silent, that you may hear: believe me for mine honour, and have respect to mine honour, that you may believe: censure” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus (speech 6)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus (speech 6)). Brutus's balanced antithesis. That is rhetoric at work: Brutus's speech is in prose, logical and restrained ("Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more"); Antony's is verse, emotional, ironic and dramatic, with the will and the body as props.

> *Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more* (Act III, Scene II, Brutus (speech 6))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus (speech 6)). Brutus's balanced antithesis. That is rhetoric at work: Brutus's speech is in prose, logical and restrained ("Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more"); Antony's is verse, emotional, ironic and dramatic, with the will and the body as props.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The repetition becomes ironic: each time, the evidence against Brutus grows. Rhetoric and persuasion. Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion? Expected: The scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. (The repeated ironic refrain.)

> *For Brutus is an honourable man* (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The repetition becomes ironic: each time, the evidence against Brutus grows. Rhetoric and persuasion.
Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion?
Expected answer: The scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. (The repeated ironic refrain.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for rhetoric, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the funeral orations? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of the funeral orations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. When the text says "For Brutus is an honourable man" (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)), it shows this directly. Brutus rests his case on honour ("I loved Rome more"), so Antony repeats "Brutus is an honourable man" until the phrase sounds false, while showing the wounds and the will to move the crowd.
Task: Annotate the scene for rhetoric, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the funeral orations? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of the funeral orations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. When the text says "For Brutus is an honourable man" (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)), it shows this directly. Brutus rests his case on honour ("I loved Rome more"), so Antony repeats "Brutus is an honourable man" until the phrase sounds false, while showing the wounds and the will to move the crowd.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why? Have students chart the crowd's reactions across the scene.
Anchor question: Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why?
Facilitation: Have students chart the crowd's reactions across the scene.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the funeral orations? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. ("For Brutus is an honourable man", Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the funeral orations? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. ("For Brutus is an honourable man", Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how rhetoric shapes the funeral orations. Key takeaway: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Rhetoric:** Brutus's speech is in prose, logical and restrained ("Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more"); Antony's is verse, emotional, ironic and dramatic, with the will and the body as props.
- **Irony:** Antony's repeated "Brutus is an honourable man" turns praise into accusation.
- **Structure:** The crowd's lines show their shifts in real time.

Themes and how they develop

- **rhetoric and persuasion:** the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos.

Symbols and motifs

- **honour:** "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “be silent, that you may hear: believe me for mine honour, and have respect to mine honour, that you may believe: censure” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus (speech 6)).
- **blood:** Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: “dead Caesar’s wounds / And dip their napkins in his sacred blood, / Yea, beg a hair of him for memory, / And, dying, mention” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 39)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus (speech 6)) Brutus's balanced antithesis.
- “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)) Antony's opening.
- “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)) The repeated ironic refrain.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him.
Evidence: “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30))
Reasoning: Brutus rests his case on honour ("I loved Rome more"), so Antony repeats "Brutus is an honourable man" until the phrase sounds false, while showing the wounds and the will to move the crowd.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
extenuated (verb)	played down; made to seem less	*The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
withholds (verb)	holds back	*You all did love him once, not without cause: What cause withholds you then, to mourn for him?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ransoms (noun)	payments to free captives	*He hath brought many captives home to Rome, Whose ransoms did the general coffers fill: Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
drachmas (noun)	silver coins	*To every Roman citizen he gives, To every several man, seventy-five drachmas.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disprove (verb)	to show to be false	*I speak not to disprove what Brutus spoke, But here I am to speak what I do know.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
daggers (noun)	short knives used as weapons	*I have o'ershot myself to tell you of it: I fear I wrong the honourable men Whose daggers have stabb'd Caesar; I do fear it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vesture (noun)	clothing; here, Caesar's cloak	*Kind souls, what, weep you when you but behold Our Caesar's vesture wounded?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
brutish (adjective)	like a beast; without reason	*O judgment! thou art fled to brutish beasts, And men have lost their reason.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
villains (noun)	base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers)	*They were villains, murderers: the will! read the will.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bondman (noun)	a slave	*Who is here so base that would be a bondman?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why?
2. Where does theme appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate, omens and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Antony say Caesar did when offered the crown three times on the Lupercal? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He refused it each time.
2. Does Brutus speak to the crowd in prose or verse? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Prose
3. What phrase does Antony repeat about Brutus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Brutus is an honourable man
4. How much money does Caesar's will leave each citizen? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Seventy-five drachmas
5. What does Antony show the crowd? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Caesar's torn mantle and wounds
6. Why did Brutus say he killed Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Caesar was ambitious
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Brutus speaks to the plebeians in prose: he loved Caesar, but loved Rome more; Caesar was ambitious, so he killed him. The crowd cheers and even shouts to make Brutus Caesar. Brutus leaves Antony to speak. Antony, in verse, repeats that 'Brutus is an honourable man' until the phrase turns to irony; recalls Caesar refusing the crown; weeps; shows the torn, bloody mantle; and finally reads Caesar's…
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death." What does "extenuated" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: extenuated: played down; made to seem less.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Antony hold back the will until late in the speech? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: To build curiosity and anger so its reading sets off the riot.
2. What does "Act III, Scene II" suggest about the funeral orations? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence.
3. Find one example of theme in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the funeral orations? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus (speech 6)): Brutus's balanced antithesis. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Then none have I offended.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Brutus speaks to the plebeians in prose: he loved Caesar, but loved Rome more; Caesar was ambitious, so he killed him. The crowd cheers and even shouts to make Brutus Caesar. Brutus leaves Antony to speak. Antony, in verse, repeats that 'Brutus is an honourable man' until the phrase turns to irony;…
7. How does “Act III, Scene II” build on “Act III, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)): Antony's opening. On structure: The crowd's lines show their shifts in real time. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)): The repeated ironic refrain. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate, omens and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus (speech 6)): Brutus's balanced antithesis. On structure: The crowd's lines show their shifts in real time. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Antony's speech honest? Separate true statements from manipulations. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: True facts (refused crown, the will) serve a manipulative design.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)): Antony's opening. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)): The repeated ironic refrain. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus (speech 6)): Brutus's balanced antithesis. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the funeral orations. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)): Antony's opening. On structure: The crowd's lines show their shifts in real time. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)): The repeated ironic refrain. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to power, ambition and tyranny: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III,

Scene II, Brutus (speech 6)): Brutus's balanced antithesis. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the theme in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)): Antony's opening. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act III, Scene II” treats the funeral orations with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “For Brutus is an honourable man” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)): The repeated ironic refrain. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Not that I loved Caesar less, but that I loved Rome more” (Act III, Scene II, Brutus (speech 6)): Brutus's balanced antithesis. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the funeral orations? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antony defeats Brutus by turning Brutus's own key word against him. Useful evidence: “Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears” (Act III, Scene II, Antony (speech 30)): Antony's opening. Theme link: the scene is a masterclass in ethos, pathos and logos. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz

1. Does Brutus speak to the crowd in prose or verse?
   A. Prose
   B. Verse
   C. Latin
   D. Song
2. What phrase does Antony repeat about Brutus?
   A. Brutus loved Caesar
   B. Brutus is wise
   C. Brutus is a traitor
   D. Brutus is an honourable man
3. How much money does Caesar's will leave each citizen?
   A. Ten drachmas
   B. One hundred talents
   C. Seventy-five drachmas
   D. Nothing
4. What does Antony show the crowd?
   A. A crown
   B. The conspirators' letters
   C. Caesar's torn mantle and wounds
   D. A dagger
5. Why did Brutus say he killed Caesar?
   A. The gods ordered it
   B. Caesar stole money
   C. Caesar was ambitious
   D. Caesar was cruel to him
6. In the line “The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death.”, what does “extenuated” most nearly mean?
   A. silver coins
   B. played down; made to seem less
   C. holds back
   D. payments to free captives
7. In the line “You all did love him once, not without cause: What cause withholds you then, to mourn for him?”, what does “withholds” most nearly mean?
   A. payments to free captives
   B. silver coins
   C. played down; made to seem less
   D. holds back

Answer key: 1. A (Prose); 2. D (Brutus is an honourable man); 3. C (Seventy-five drachmas); 4. C (Caesar's torn mantle and wounds); 5. C (Caesar was ambitious); 6. B (played down; made to seem less); 7. D (holds back)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show the funeral orations? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the funeral orations? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of the funeral orations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of the funeral orations. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene II suggests about the funeral orations. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's theme and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses theme in Act III, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the funeral orations. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the funeral orations responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the funeral orations follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene II and its treatment of the funeral orations. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's theme and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the funeral orations in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the funeral orations. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *He hath brought many captives home to Rome, Whose ransoms did the general coffers fill: Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ransoms” most nearly mean?

   A. like a beast; without reason

   B. payments to free captives

   C. base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers)

   D. a slave

2. *Then none have I offended. I have done no more to Caesar than you shall do to Brutus. The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene II”?

   A. The assassination

   B. The funeral orations

   C. The triumvirs' proscription list

   D. Cassius works on Brutus

SAT key: 1. B (payments to free captives); 2. B (The funeral orations)

Lesson 12: Act III, Scene III

Focus: Cinna the poet

Content note (mob violence): An innocent poet is killed by a mob that confuses his name with a conspirator's. Discuss the link between rhetoric and crowd violence without dwelling on the act.
Student preview: A crowd attacks an innocent man.
Suggested language: "What made this crowd stop listening?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Cinna the poet, who has dreamed of feasting with Caesar, goes out to the funeral. A mob of plebeians questions him. When he gives his name, they confuse him with Cinna the conspirator; when he protests that he is the poet, they cry 'Tear him for his bad verses' and kill him anyway.

Background: Plutarch reports that the poet Helvius Cinna was killed by a mob that mistook him for the conspirator Cornelius Cinna.

Significance: This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What happens to truth when a crowd is angry? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because.... Content note before we start: A crowd attacks an innocent man.
Prompt: What happens to truth when a crowd is angry?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to rhetoric and persuasion because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: bachelor — an unmarried man; funeral — a ceremony for a dead person; provender — food for horses; errands — small tasks for others; appoint — to provide for; to equip.
Words: bachelor: an unmarried man · funeral: a ceremony for a dead person · provender: food for horses · errands: small tasks for others · appoint: to provide for; to equip

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plutarch reports that the poet Helvius Cinna was killed by a mob that mistook him for the conspirator Cornelius Cinna. This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students. Plot: The mob kills Cinna the poet because he shares a conspirator's name. Tone / mood: Dark comedy turning brutal. Watch for omens and portents: Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "I dreamt to-night that I did feast with Caesar, / And things unluckily charge" (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 1)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet" (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)). His plea. That is plot at work: The mob kills Cinna the poet because he shares a conspirator's name.

> *I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet* (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet" (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)). His plea. That is plot at work: The mob kills Cinna the poet because he shares a conspirator's name.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The mob's cruelty. Look at the craft: Dark comedy turning brutal. Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion? Expected: The crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. (The mob's cruelty.)

> *Tear him for his bad verses* (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 22))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The mob's cruelty. Look at the craft: Dark comedy turning brutal.
Ask: How does this line connect to rhetoric and persuasion?
Expected answer: The crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. (The mob's cruelty.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for plot, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Cinna the poet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Cinna the poet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. When the text says “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)), it shows this directly. When he protests "I am Cinna the poet," the mob answers "It is no matter, his name's Cinna" and "Tear him for his bad verses."
Task: Annotate the scene for plot, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Cinna the poet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Cinna the poet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. When the text says “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)), it shows this directly. When he protests "I am Cinna the poet," the mob answers "It is no matter, his name's Cinna" and "Tear him for his bad verses."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What happens to truth when a crowd is angry? Ask: who is responsible for Cinna's death?
Anchor question: What happens to truth when a crowd is angry?
Facilitation: Ask: who is responsible for Cinna's death?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Cinna the poet? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. (“I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet”, Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Cinna the poet? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. (“I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet”, Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes Cinna the poet. Key takeaway: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** The mob kills Cinna the poet because he shares a conspirator's name.
- **Tone / mood:** Dark comedy turning brutal.

Themes and how they develop

- **rhetoric and persuasion:** the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob.

Symbols and motifs

- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: “I dreamt to-night that I did feast with Caesar, / And things unluckily charge” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 1)).
- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: “Enter Citizens” (Act III, Scene III, speech (speech 1)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)) His plea.
- “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 22)) The mob's cruelty.
- “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 24)) The mob's logic.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd.
Evidence: “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21))
Reasoning: When he protests "I am Cinna the poet," the mob answers "It is no matter, his name's Cinna" and "Tear him for his bad verses."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bachelor (noun)	an unmarried man	*Are you a married man or a bachelor?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
funeral (noun)	a ceremony for a dead person	*Directly, I am going to Caesar’s funeral.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
provender (noun)	food for horses	*So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern’d by my spirit.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

errands (noun)	small tasks for others	*This is a slight unmeritable man, Meet to be sent on errands: is it fit, The three-fold world divided, he should stand One of the three to share it?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
appoint (verb)	to provide for; to equip	*So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conference (noun)	a private talk	*With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enlarge (verb)	to state freely; to explain fully	*Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ceremony (noun)	formal politeness	*Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What happens to truth when a crowd is angry?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What questions does the mob ask Cinna? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His name, where he is going, where he lives, whether he is married.
2. Why does the mob attack Cinna the poet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He shares a name with a conspirator
3. What did Cinna dream before going out? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: That he feasted with Caesar
4. Where is Cinna going? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To Caesar's funeral
5. What do the plebeians say to tear him for? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His bad verses

6. Does the mob stop when they learn he is the poet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: No
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Cinna the poet, who has dreamed of feasting with Caesar, goes out to the funeral. A mob of plebeians questions him. When he gives his name, they confuse him with Cinna the conspirator; when he protests that he is the poet, they cry 'Tear him for his bad verses' and kill him anyway.
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Are you a married man or a bachelor?" What does "bachelor" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: bachelor: an unmarried man.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Shakespeare include this scene right after the orations? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: To show the human cost of inflamed rhetoric.
2. What does "Act III, Scene III" suggest about Cinna the poet? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about Cinna the poet? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: "I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet" (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)): His plea. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "What is my name?", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act III, Scene III", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Cinna the poet, who has dreamed of feasting with Caesar, goes out to the funeral. A mob of plebeians questions him. When he gives his name, they confuse him with Cinna the conspirator; when he protests that he is the poet, they cry 'Tear him for his bad verses' and kill him anyway.
7. How does "Act III, Scene III" build on "Act III, Scene II"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of

rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 22)): The mob's cruelty. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 24)): The mob's logic. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What happens to truth when a crowd is angry?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)): His plea. On tone / mood: Dark comedy turning brutal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is this scene comic, horrifying, or both? How would you stage it, and why? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Accept justified choices; note the dark humor and violence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 22)): The mob's cruelty. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 24)): The mob's logic. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of

rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)): His plea. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Cinna the poet. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 22)): The mob's cruelty. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 24)): The mob's logic. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet” (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)): His plea. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “Tear him for his bad verses” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 22)): The mob's cruelty. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene III” treats Cinna the poet with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: “It is no matter, his name’s Cinna” (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 24)): The mob's logic. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act IV, Scene I" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: "I am Cinna the poet, I am Cinna the poet" (Act III, Scene III, Cinna (speech 21)): His plea. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Cinna the poet? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Cinna the poet shows the danger of rhetoric that inflames a crowd. Useful evidence: "Tear him for his bad verses" (Act III, Scene III, Fourth Citizen (speech 22)): The mob's cruelty. Theme link: the crowd Antony stirred becomes a lynch mob. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Why does the mob attack Cinna the poet?
   A. He praised Brutus
   B. He shares a name with a conspirator
   C. He stole from them
   D. He insulted Caesar
2. What did Cinna dream before going out?
   A. That Caesar was crowned
   B. That he was attacked
   C. That he feasted with Caesar
   D. That Rome burned
3. Where is Cinna going?
   A. To Brutus's house
   B. To Caesar's funeral
   C. Out of Rome
   D. To the Senate

4. What do the plebeians say to tear him for?
   A. His lies
   B. His bad verses
   C. His wealth
   D. His dreams
5. Does the mob stop when they learn he is the poet?
   A. Only for a moment, then let him go
   B. No
   C. Yes
   D. They apologize
6. In the line "Are you a married man or a bachelor?", what does "bachelor" most nearly mean?
   A. food for horses
   B. an unmarried man
   C. a ceremony for a dead person
   D. small tasks for others
7. In the line "Directly, I am going to Caesar's funeral.", what does "funeral" most nearly mean?
   A. small tasks for others
   B. a ceremony for a dead person
   C. food for horses
   D. an unmarried man

Answer key: 1. B (He shares a name with a conspirator); 2. C (That he feasted with Caesar); 3. B (To Caesar's funeral); 4. B (His bad verses); 5. B (No); 6. B (an unmarried man); 7. B (a ceremony for a dead person)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene III," how does Shakespeare show Cinna the poet? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act III, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Cinna the poet? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Cinna the poet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of Cinna the

poet. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene III suggests about Cinna the poet. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act III, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Cinna the poet. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Cinna the poet responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Cinna the poet follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene III and its treatment of Cinna the poet. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Cinna the poet in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Cinna the poet. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “provender” most nearly mean?

   A. a private talk

   B. to state freely; to explain fully

   C. formal politeness

D. food for horses

2. *What is my name? Whither am I going? Where do I dwell? Am I a married man or a bachelor? Then, to answer every man directly and briefly, wisely and truly: wisely I say, I am a bachelor.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene III"?

A. The triumvirs' proscription list

B. Cinna the poet

C. Cassius works on Brutus

D. Parley before battle

SAT key: 1. D (food for horses); 2. B (Cinna the poet)

Lesson 13: Act IV, Scene I

Focus: the triumvirs' proscription list

Teacher only · spoilers

Antony, Octavius and Lepidus mark men for death, trading relatives: Lepidus's brother and Antony's nephew are condemned. Antony plans to cut costs from Caesar's will. When Lepidus leaves, Antony calls him a 'slight unmeritable man' fit only for errands, comparing him to a horse; Octavius defends him as a soldier. They plan to meet the armies of Brutus and Cassius.

Background: In 43 BC the Second Triumvirate published proscription lists of enemies to be killed and their property seized; the orator Cicero was among the victims.

Significance: The 'avengers' of Caesar prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to power and ambition because....
Prompt: Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples.
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to power and ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: provender — food for horses; errands — small tasks for others; appoint — to provide for; to equip; conference — a private talk; enlarge — to state freely; to explain fully.
Words: provender: food for horses · errands: small tasks for others · appoint: to provide for; to equip · conference: a private talk · enlarge: to state freely; to explain fully

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
In 43 BC the Second Triumvirate published proscription lists of enemies to be killed and their property seized; the orator Cicero was among the victims. The 'avengers' of Caesar prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech. Characterization: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back. Irony: Antony, who praised Caesar's love for the people, now cuts legacies from Caesar's will. Watch for Rome and the people: The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: "A house in Rome" (Act IV, Scene I, speech (speech 0)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "These many, then, shall die; their names are prick'd" (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 1)). The proscription. That is characterization at work: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back.

> *These many, then, shall die; their names are prick'd* (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 1))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "These many, then, shall die; their names are prick'd" (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 1)). The proscription. That is characterization at work: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Antony on Lepidus. Look at the craft: Antony, who praised Caesar's love for the people, now cuts legacies from Caesar's will. Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition? Expected: The new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. (Antony on Lepidus.)

> *This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands* (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 9))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Antony on Lepidus. Look at the craft: Antony, who praised Caesar's love for the people, now cuts legacies from Caesar's will.
Ask: How does this line connect to power and ambition?
Expected answer: The new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. (Antony on Lepidus.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the triumvirs' proscription list? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the triumvirs' proscription list. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. When the text says “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 6)), it shows this directly. They begin with "These many, then, shall die," and Antony plans to "cut off some charge in legacies" from the will he used to win the crowd.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the triumvirs' proscription list? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the triumvirs' proscription list. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. When the text says “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 6)), it shows this directly. They begin with "These many, then, shall die," and Antony plans to "cut off some charge in legacies" from the will he used to win the crowd.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples. Ask: was the conspiracy worth it?

Anchor question: Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples.

Facilitation: Ask: was the conspiracy worth it?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the triumvirs' proscription list? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. (“we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies”, Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 6)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the triumvirs' proscription list? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. (“we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies”, Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 6)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the triumvirs' proscription list. Key takeaway: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back.
- **Irony:** Antony, who praised Caesar's love for the people, now cuts legacies from Caesar's will.

Themes and how they develop

- **power and ambition:** the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be.

Symbols and motifs

- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: “A house in Rome” (Act IV, Scene I, speech (speech 0)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 1)) The proscription.
- “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 9)) Antony on Lepidus.
- “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 6)) Reducing the will.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones.
Evidence: “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 6))
Reasoning: They begin with "These many, then, shall die," and Antony plans to "cut off some charge in legacies" from the will he used to win the crowd.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
provender (noun)	food for horses	*So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern’d by my spirit.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

errands (noun)	small tasks for others	*This is a slight unmeritable man, Meet to be sent on errands: is it fit, The three-fold world divided, he should stand One of the three to share it?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
appoint (verb)	to provide for; to equip	*So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conference (noun)	a private talk	*With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enlarge (verb)	to state freely; to explain fully	*Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ceremony (noun)	formal politeness	*Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
jigging (adjective)	rhyming in a silly, sing-song way	*I'll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
counters (noun)	worthless metal tokens used in counting	*When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples.
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whose brother must die on the triumvirs' list? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lepidus's brother.
2. What are the triumvirs doing at the start of the scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Marking names of men to be killed

3. Whose nephew is condemned? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Antony's
4. What does Antony plan to do with Caesar's will? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Cut some of its charges
5. To what animal does Antony compare Lepidus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A horse
6. Who defends Lepidus as a tried and valiant soldier? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Octavius
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus mark men for death, trading relatives: Lepidus's brother and Antony's nephew are condemned. Antony plans to cut costs from Caesar's will. When Lepidus leaves, Antony calls him a 'slight unmeritable man' fit only for errands, comparing him to a horse; Octavius defends him as a soldier. They plan to meet the armies of Brutus and Cassius.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit." What does "provender" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: provender: food for horses.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does the scene reveal about how Antony views power? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: As a matter of tools and advantage; allies are used and discarded.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene I" suggest about the triumvirs' proscription list? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The 'avengers' of Caesar prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about the triumvirs' proscription list? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: "These many, then, shall die; their names are prick'd" (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 1)): The proscription. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion…", why might

Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus mark men for death, trading relatives: Lepidus's brother and Antony's nephew are condemned. Antony plans to cut costs from Caesar's will. When Lepidus leaves, Antony calls him a 'slight unmeritable man' fit only for errands, comparing him to a horse; Octavius defends…
7. How does “Act IV, Scene I” build on “Act III, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 9)): Antony on Lepidus. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 6)): Reducing the will. On characterization: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 1)): The proscription. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Compare this scene with Antony's funeral speech. Which shows the 'real' Antony? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Strong answers see both as performances of one strategic self.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 9)): Antony on Lepidus. Theme link: the new rulers are as

ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The 'avengers' of Caesar prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 6)): Reducing the will. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 1)): The proscription. On characterization: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the triumvirs' proscription list. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 9)): Antony on Lepidus. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 6)): Reducing the will. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 1)): The proscription. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 9)): Antony on Lepidus. On characterization: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus draw up a death list; Antony mocks Lepidus behind his back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene I” treats the triumvirs' proscription list with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “we shall determine / How to cut off some charge in legacies” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 6)): Reducing the will. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “These many, then, shall die; their names are prick’d” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 1)): The proscription. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the triumvirs' proscription list? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The triumvirate shows that Caesar's death has replaced one ruler with three ruthless ones. Useful evidence: “This is a slight unmeritable man, / Meet to be sent on errands” (Act IV, Scene I, Antony (speech 9)): Antony on Lepidus. Theme link: the new rulers are as ruthless as the conspirators feared Caesar would be. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz

1. What are the triumvirs doing at the start of the scene?

   A. Planning Caesar's funeral

   B. Marking names of men to be killed

C. Writing laws

D. Dividing the army

2. Whose nephew is condemned?

A. Lepidus's

B. Antony's

C. Octavius's

D. Brutus's

3. What does Antony plan to do with Caesar's will?

A. Read it again

B. Give more to the people

C. Cut some of its charges

D. Burn it

4. To what animal does Antony compare Lepidus?

A. A lion

B. A donkey

C. A dog

D. A horse

5. Who defends Lepidus as a tried and valiant soldier?

A. Antony

B. Brutus

C. Octavius

D. Cassius

6. In the line "So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.", what does "provender" most nearly mean?

A. a private talk

B. food for horses

C. small tasks for others

D. to provide for; to equip

7. In the line "This is a slight unmeritable man, Meet to be sent on errands: is it fit, The three-fold world divided, he should stand One of the three to share it?", what does "errands" most nearly mean?

A. to provide for; to equip

B. food for horses

C. a private talk

D. small tasks for others

Answer key: 1. B (Marking names of men to be killed); 2. B (Antony's); 3. C (Cut some of its charges); 4. D (A horse); 5. C (Octavius); 6. B (food for horses); 7. D (small tasks for others)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the triumvirs' proscription list? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the triumvirs' proscription list? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the triumvirs' proscription list. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the triumvirs' proscription list. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene I suggests about the triumvirs' proscription list. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act IV, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the triumvirs' proscription list. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act IV, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the triumvirs' proscription list responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act IV, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the triumvirs' proscription list follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene I and its treatment of the triumvirs' proscription list. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the triumvirs' proscription list in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the triumvirs' proscription list. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "appoint" most nearly mean?

   A. to provide for; to equip

   B. worthless metal tokens used in counting

   C. formal politeness

   D. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way

2. *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit. And, in some taste, is Lepidus but so; He must be taught and train'd and bid go forth; A barren-spirited fellow; one that feeds On abjects, orts and imitations, Which, out of use and staled by other men, Begin his fashion: do not talk of him, But as a property. And now, Octavius, Listen great things:—Brutus and Cassius Are levying powers: we must straight make head: Therefore let our alliance be combined, Our best friends made, our means stretch'd; And let us presently go sit in council, How covert matters may be best disclosed, And open perils surest answered.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene I"?

   A. The assassination

   B. Portia's anxiety

   C. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

   D. The triumvirs' proscription list

SAT key: 1. A (to provide for; to equip); 2. D (The triumvirs' proscription list)

Lesson 14: Act IV, Scene II

Focus: Brutus and Cassius at odds

Teacher only · spoilers

At his camp near Sardis, Brutus tells Lucilius that Cassius greets him with cold ceremony, like a hot horse that fails under trial. Cassius arrives angry, saying Brutus has wronged him. Brutus stops him from quarreling before their armies and moves the conversation into his tent.

Background: Sardis was a city in Asia Minor (modern Turkey) where Brutus and Cassius gathered forces after leaving Rome.

Significance: The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might friends who share a cause still fall out? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to friendship and loyalty because....
Prompt: Why might friends who share a cause still fall out?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to friendship and loyalty because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the friendship under strain.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: conference — a private talk; enlarge — to state freely; to explain fully; ceremony — formal politeness; jigging — rhyming in a silly, sing-song way; counters — worthless metal tokens used in counting.
Words: conference: a private talk · enlarge: to state freely; to explain fully · ceremony: formal politeness · jigging: rhyming in a silly, sing-song way · counters: worthless metal tokens used in counting

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Sardis was a city in Asia Minor (modern Turkey) where Brutus and Cassius gathered forces after leaving Rome. The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor. Characterization: Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent. Foreshadowing: Their alliance is cracking. Watch for honour: "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: "will appear / Such as he is, full of regard and honour" (Act IV, Scene II, Pindarus (speech 6)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony" (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)). Brutus on cooling friendship. That is characterization at work: Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent.

> *When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony* (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony" (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)). Brutus on cooling friendship. That is characterization at work: Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Cassius's accusation. Look at the craft: Their alliance is cracking. Ask: How does this line connect to friendship and loyalty? Expected: The friendship under strain. (Cassius's accusation.)

> *Most noble brother, you have done me wrong* (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius (speech 17))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Cassius's accusation. Look at the craft: Their alliance is cracking.
Ask: How does this line connect to friendship and loyalty?
Expected answer: The friendship under strain. (Cassius's accusation.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Brutus and Cassius at odds? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. When the text says "When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony" (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)), it shows this directly. Brutus observes that when love "begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Brutus and Cassius at odds? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. When the text says "When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony" (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)), it shows this directly. Brutus observes that when love "begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might friends who share a cause still fall out? Ask: why does Brutus care so much about the armies seeing?
Anchor question: Why might friends who share a cause still fall out?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Brutus care so much about the armies seeing?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Brutus and Cassius at odds? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. ("When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony", Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Brutus and Cassius at odds? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. ("When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony", Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Brutus and Cassius at odds. Key takeaway: the friendship under strain.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent.
- **Foreshadowing:** Their alliance is cracking.

Themes and how they develop

- **friendship and loyalty:** the friendship under strain.

Symbols and motifs

- **honour:** "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “will appear / Such as he is, full of regard and honour” (Act IV, Scene II, Pindarus (speech 6)).
- **blood:** Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: “promise of their mettle; / But when they should endure the bloody spur, / They fall their crests, and, like deceitful jades, / Sink in” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)) Brutus on cooling friendship.
- “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius (speech 17)) Cassius's accusation.
- “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 20)) Brutus's concern for appearance.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing.
Evidence: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9))
Reasoning: Brutus observes that when love "begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
conference (noun)	a private talk		

		With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old.	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enlarge (verb)	to state freely; to explain fully	*Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ceremony (noun)	formal politeness	*Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
jigging (adjective)	rhyming in a silly, sing-song way	*I'll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
counters (noun)	worthless metal tokens used in counting	*When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
niggard (verb)	to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)	*The deep of night is crept upon our talk, And nature must obey necessity; Which we will niggard with a little rest.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
itching (adjective)	greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)	*Let me tell you, Cassius, you yourself Are much condemn'd to have an itching palm; To sell and mart your offices for gold To undeservers.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
thunderbolts (noun)	bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon)	*When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why might friends who share a cause still fall out?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who brings news of Cassius's approach and his cold manner? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lucilius (with Pindarus, Cassius's servant).
2. How does Lucilius say Cassius received him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: With courtesy but not old friendliness
3. To what does Brutus compare a cooling friend? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Horses that fail under trial
4. Where does Brutus want to argue with Cassius? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Inside his tent
5. What does Cassius accuse Brutus of? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Wronging him
6. Near which city is Brutus's camp? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Sardis
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: At his camp near Sardis, Brutus tells Lucilius that Cassius greets him with cold ceremony, like a hot horse that fails under trial. Cassius arrives angry, saying Brutus has wronged him. Brutus stops him from quarreling before their armies and moves the conversation into his tent.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old." What does "conference" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: conference: a private talk.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Brutus insist the quarrel move into the tent? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: So the soldiers do not see their leaders divided.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene II" suggest about Brutus and Cassius at odds? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Brutus and Cassius at odds? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: "When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony" (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)): Brutus on cooling friendship. On characterization: Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: At his camp near Sardis, Brutus tells Lucilius that Cassius greets him with cold ceremony, like a hot horse that fails under trial. Cassius arrives angry, saying Brutus has wronged him. Brutus stops him from quarreling before their armies and moves the conversation into his tent.
7. How does “Act IV, Scene II” build on “Act IV, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius (speech 17)): Cassius's accusation. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 20)): Brutus's concern for appearance. On characterization: Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might friends who share a cause still fall out?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)): Brutus on cooling friendship. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Brutus right to care so much about appearances in front of the army? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Accept leadership arguments; link to his public-honor theme.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV,

Scene II, Cassius (speech 17)): Cassius's accusation. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 20)): Brutus's concern for appearance. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)): Brutus on cooling friendship. On characterization: Brutus and Cassius meet in tension; Brutus asks to talk privately in his tent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Brutus and Cassius at odds. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius (speech 17)): Cassius's accusation. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 20)): Brutus's concern for appearance. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)): Brutus on cooling friendship. Theme link: the

friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius (speech 17)): Cassius's accusation. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene II” treats Brutus and Cassius at odds with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Before the eyes of both our armies here” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 20)): Brutus's concern for appearance. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “When love begins to sicken and decay, / It useth an enforced ceremony” (Act IV, Scene II, Brutus (speech 9)): Brutus on cooling friendship. On foreshadowing: Their alliance is cracking. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Brutus and Cassius at odds? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel begins publicly, showing that the conspiracy's unity is collapsing. Useful evidence: “Most noble brother, you have done me wrong” (Act IV, Scene II, Cassius (speech 17)): Cassius's accusation. Theme link: the friendship under strain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz

1. How does Lucilius say Cassius received him?
   A. With great warmth
   B. With open anger
   C. With courtesy but not old friendliness
   D. With tears
2. To what does Brutus compare a cooling friend?
   A. Old wine
   B. Horses that fail under trial
   C. A dying fire
   D. Winter
3. Where does Brutus want to argue with Cassius?
   A. Before the armies
   B. In Rome
   C. On the battlefield
   D. Inside his tent
4. What does Cassius accuse Brutus of?
   A. Loving Antony
   B. Stealing
   C. Wronging him
   D. Betraying Rome
5. Near which city is Brutus's camp?
   A. Sardis
   B. Philippi
   C. Rome
   D. Athens
6. In the line "With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old.", what does "conference" most nearly mean?
   A. to state freely; to explain fully
   B. formal politeness
   C. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way
   D. a private talk
7. In the line "Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.", what does "enlarge" most nearly mean?
   A. formal politeness
   B. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way
   C. a private talk
   D. to state freely; to explain fully

Answer key: 1. C (With courtesy but not old friendliness); 2. B (Horses that fail under trial); 3. D (Inside his tent); 4. C (Wronging him); 5. A (Sardis); 6. D (a private talk); 7. D (to state freely; to explain fully)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act IV, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show Brutus and Cassius at odds? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Brutus and Cassius at odds? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene II suggests about Brutus and Cassius at odds. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act IV, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act IV, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Brutus and Cassius at odds responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act IV, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Brutus and Cassius at odds follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene II and its treatment of Brutus and Cassius at odds. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Brutus and Cassius at odds in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ceremony” most nearly mean?

   A. greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)

   B. bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon)

   C. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)

   D. formal politeness

2. *Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony. There are no tricks in plain and simple faith; But hollow men, like horses hot at hand, Make gallant show and promise of their mettle; But when they should endure the bloody spur, They fall their crests, and, like deceitful jades, Sink in the trial. Comes his army on?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene II”?

   A. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

   B. Parley before battle

   C. Portia's anxiety

   D. Brutus and Cassius at odds

SAT key: 1. D (formal politeness); 2. D (Brutus and Cassius at odds)

Lesson 15: Act IV, Scene III

Focus: the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

Content note (suicide (reported)): Brutus reports that Portia 'swallow'd fire.' Use the safe-messaging script; focus on Brutus's response and the strain of the war.
Student preview: This scene reports a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: "What does Brutus's reaction show about him?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

In the tent, Cassius protests that Brutus condemned Lucius Pella for bribery despite his letters. Brutus accuses Cassius of an 'itching palm' and of refusing him gold to pay his legions, while insisting he himself will not raise money by vile means. They trade insults until Cassius offers Brutus his dagger and his heart; they reconcile. Brutus reveals that Portia is dead: she 'swallow'd fire.' Messala brings news that the triumvirs have killed many senators (seventy or a hundred), Cicero among them. Brutus overrules Cassius again and decides to march to Philippi: 'There is a tide in the affairs of men.' Late at night, as Lucius sleeps, Caesar's ghost appears and says Brutus will see him at Philippi.

Background: Plutarch reports that Brutus saw a spirit before the battle, calling itself his evil genius. Portia's death is reported in two ways in the scene (Brutus tells Cassius, then appears to learn it again from Messala), which many editors think shows two versions of the scene surviving in the Folio.

Significance: The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to friendship and loyalty because.... Content note before we start: This scene reports a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to friendship and loyalty because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: friendship saved, but the cause doomed.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: jigging — rhyming in a silly, sing-song way; counters — worthless metal tokens used in counting; niggard — to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep); itching — greedy (an itching palm wants bribes); thunderbolts — bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon).
Words: jigging: rhyming in a silly, sing-song way · counters: worthless metal tokens used in counting · niggard: to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep) · itching: greedy (an itching palm wants bribes) · thunderbolts: bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon)

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plutarch reports that Brutus saw a spirit before the battle, calling itself his evil genius. Portia's death is reported in two ways in the scene (Brutus tells Cassius, then appears to learn it again from Messala), which many editors think shows two versions of the scene surviving in the Folio. The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students. Dialogue: The quarrel: Brutus accuses Cassius of corruption; Cassius accuses Brutus of not loving him; they reconcile. Characterization: Brutus reveals Portia's death calmly; the ghost of Caesar appears. Structure: The scene moves from rage to tenderness to the supernatural. Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Pella / For taking bribes here of the Sardians; / Wherein my letters, praying on his side, / Because I knew the man, were slighted" (Act IV, Scene III, Cassius (speech 1)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Portia is dead" (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 65)). Brutus's restraint. That is dialogue at work: The quarrel: Brutus accuses Cassius of corruption; Cassius accuses Brutus of not loving him; they reconcile.

> *Portia is dead (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 65))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Portia is dead" (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 65)). Brutus's restraint. That is dialogue at work: The quarrel: Brutus accuses Cassius of corruption; Cassius accuses Brutus of not loving him; they reconcile.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The tide metaphor argues for seizing the moment; ironically it leads to defeat. Ask: How does this line connect to friendship and loyalty? Expected: Friendship saved, but the cause doomed. (Brutus's argument for attacking.)

> *There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The tide metaphor argues for seizing the moment; ironically it leads to defeat.
Ask: How does this line connect to friendship and loyalty?
Expected answer: Friendship saved, but the cause doomed. (Brutus's argument for attacking.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. When the text says "There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune" (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101)), it shows this directly. He reveals "Portia is dead" with stoic calm, then overrules Cassius with "There is a tide in the affairs of men," a metaphor that leads to Philippi.
Task: Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. When the text says "There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune" (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101)), it shows this directly. He reveals "Portia is dead" with stoic calm, then overrules Cassius with "There is a tide in the affairs of men," a metaphor that leads to Philippi.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost? Ask: why do audiences love this scene (see Digges in the intro)?
Anchor question: Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost?
Facilitation: Ask: why do audiences love this scene (see Digges in the intro)?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. ("There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune", Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. ("There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune", Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dialogue shapes the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Key takeaway: friendship saved, but the cause doomed.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dialogue:** The quarrel: Brutus accuses Cassius of corruption; Cassius accuses Brutus of not loving him; they reconcile.
- **Characterization:** Brutus reveals Portia's death calmly; the ghost of Caesar appears.
- **Structure:** The scene moves from rage to tenderness to the supernatural.

Themes and how they develop

- **friendship and loyalty:** friendship saved, but the cause doomed.

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Pella / For taking bribes here of the Sardians; / Wherein my letters, praying on his side, / Because I knew the man, were slighted" (Act IV, Scene III, Cassius (speech 1)).
- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "Remember March, the ides of March remember: / Did not great Julius bleed for justice' sake" (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 8)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101)) Brutus's argument for attacking.
- “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 65)) Brutus's restraint.
- “Thy evil spirit, Brutus” (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost (speech 127)) The ghost.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence.
Evidence: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101))
Reasoning: He reveals "Portia is dead" with stoic calm, then overrules Cassius with "There is a tide in the affairs of men," a metaphor that leads to Philippi.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
jigging (adjective)	rhyming in a silly, sing-song way	*I'll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
counters (noun)	worthless metal tokens used in counting	*When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
niggard (verb)	to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)	*The deep of night is crept upon our talk, And nature must obey necessity; Which we will niggard with a little rest.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
itching (adjective)	greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)	*Let me tell you, Cassius, you yourself Are much condemn'd to have an itching palm; To sell and mart your offices for gold To undeservers.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
thunderbolts (noun)	bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon)	*When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
meditating (verb)	reflect deeply on a subject	*We must die, Messala: With meditating that she must die once, I have the patience to endure it now.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
accidental (adjective)	happening by chance	*Of your philosophy you make no use, If you give place to accidental evils.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
commend (verb)	to send greetings; to recommend	*Go and commend me to my brother Cassius; Bid him set on his powers betimes before, And we will follow.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which famous senator does Messala report was killed by the triumvirs? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Cicero.
2. What does Brutus accuse Cassius of having? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: An itching palm
3. Why is Brutus angry that Cassius denied him gold? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He needed it to pay his legions
4. How did Portia die, as Brutus reports? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: She swallowed fire
5. Where does Brutus decide to march? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To Philippi
6. What does the ghost tell Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He will see him at Philippi
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act IV, Scene III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: In the tent, Cassius protests that Brutus condemned Lucius Pella for bribery despite his letters. Brutus accuses Cassius of an 'itching palm' and of refusing him gold to pay his legions, while insisting he himself will not raise money by vile means. They trade insults until Cassius offers Brutus his dagger and his heart; they reconcile. Brutus reveals that Portia is dead: she 'swallow'd fire.'…
8. Who is on stage in “Act IV, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act IV, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I’ll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?” What does “jigging” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: jigging: rhyming in a silly, sing-song way.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Brutus hide his grief about Portia when Messala brings the news? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: To appear stoic and steady in front of his officers.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene III" suggest about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: "There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune" (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101)): Brutus's argument for attacking. On characterization: Brutus reveals Portia's death calmly; the ghost of Caesar appears. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "That you have wrong'd me doth appear in this: You have condemn'd and noted Lucius Pella For taking bribes here of the Sardians; Wherein my letters, praying on his side, Because I…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act IV, Scene III", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: In the tent, Cassius protests that Brutus condemned Lucius Pella for bribery despite his letters. Brutus accuses Cassius of an 'itching palm' and of refusing him gold to pay his legions, while insisting he himself will not raise money by vile means. They trade insults until Cassius offers Brutus…
7. How does "Act IV, Scene III" build on "Act IV, Scene II"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: "Portia is dead" (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 65)): Brutus's restraint. On structure: The scene moves from rage to tenderness to the supernatural. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: "Thy evil spirit, Brutus" (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost (speech 127)): The ghost. On characterization: Brutus reveals Portia's death calmly; the ghost of Caesar appears. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: "Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101)): Brutus's argument for attacking. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Brutus refuses to raise money by 'vile means' but expects Cassius's gold. Is that hypocrisy or idealism? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Strong answers note he benefits from methods he condemns.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 65)): Brutus's restraint. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Thy evil spirit, Brutus” (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost (speech 127)): The ghost. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101)): Brutus's argument for attacking. On characterization: Brutus reveals Portia's death calmly; the ghost of Caesar appears. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 65)): Brutus's restraint. On structure: The scene moves from rage to tenderness to the supernatural. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal

confidence. Useful evidence: “Thy evil spirit, Brutus” (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost (speech 127)): The ghost. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101)): Brutus's argument for attacking. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 65)): Brutus's restraint. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene III” treats the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Thy evil spirit, Brutus” (Act IV, Scene III, Ghost (speech 127)): The ghost. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “There is a tide in the affairs of men, / Which, taken at the flood, leads on to fortune” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 101)): Brutus's argument for attacking. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The tent scene shows Brutus's nobility and his fatal confidence. Useful evidence: “Portia is dead” (Act IV, Scene III, Brutus (speech 65)): Brutus's restraint. Theme link: friendship saved, but the cause doomed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What does Brutus accuse Cassius of having?
   A. A coward's tongue
   B. A cold heart
   C. An itching palm
   D. A traitor's face
2. Why is Brutus angry that Cassius denied him gold?
   A. He wanted to bribe Antony
   B. He owed Portia
   C. He needed it to pay his legions
   D. He wanted to buy a crown
3. How did Portia die, as Brutus reports?
   A. She swallowed fire
   B. She fell ill
   C. She was poisoned
   D. She drowned
4. Where does Brutus decide to march?
   A. To Philippi
   B. Back to Rome
   C. To Sardis
   D. To Egypt
5. What does the ghost tell Brutus?
   A. Portia forgives him
   B. Antony will win
   C. He should flee
   D. He will see him at Philippi
6. In the line “I’ll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?”, what does “jigging” most nearly mean?
   A. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way
   B. worthless metal tokens used in counting
   C. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)
   D. greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)

7. In the line “When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!”, what does “counters” most nearly mean?
   A. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)
   B. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way
   C. greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)
   D. worthless metal tokens used in counting

Answer key: 1. C (An itching palm); 2. C (He needed it to pay his legions); 3. A (She swallowed fire); 4. A (To Philippi); 5. D (He will see him at Philippi); 6. A (rhyming in a silly, sing-song way); 7. D (worthless metal tokens used in counting)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act IV, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act IV, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene III suggests about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act IV, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act IV, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the quarrel, Portia's

death and the ghost responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act IV, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene III and its treatment of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *The deep of night is crept upon our talk, And nature must obey necessity; Which we will niggard with a little rest.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “niggard” most nearly mean?

   A. reflect deeply on a subject

   B. to send greetings; to recommend

   C. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)

   D. happening by chance

2. *That you have wrong’d me doth appear in this: You have condemn’d and noted Lucius Pella For taking bribes here of the Sardians; Wherein my letters, praying on his side, Because I knew the man, were slighted off.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene III”?

   A. Brutus decides

   B. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

   C. Artemidorus's letter

   D. Brutus and Cassius at odds

SAT key: 1. C (to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)); 2. B (The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost)

Lesson 16: Act V, Scene I

Focus: parley before battle

Teacher only · spoilers

At Philippi, Octavius notes the enemy has come down to fight. The generals meet and exchange insults: Antony mocks the conspirators' flattery of Caesar; Cassius reminds Brutus he should have killed Antony. Octavius refuses to give way to Antony's order on the field. Cassius tells Messala it is his birthday and that he now half believes in omens: eagles have left their banners and ravens fly overhead. Brutus and Cassius say farewell, uncertain whether they will meet again; Brutus says he would not go bound to Rome.

Background: The battles of Philippi in Macedonia (42 BC) ended the republican cause. Cassius had followed Epicurus, whose followers did not believe omens.

Significance: Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do people prepare to face something they may not survive? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because....
Prompt: How do people prepare to face something they may not survive?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: stomachs — courage; appetite for battle; presage — to foretell; avenged — paid back with punishment; posture — stance; manner of attack; arguing — debating; quarreling.
Words: stomachs: courage; appetite for battle · presage: to foretell · avenged: paid back with punishment · posture: stance; manner of attack · arguing: debating; quarreling

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The battles of Philippi in Macedonia (42 BC) ended the republican cause. Cassius had followed Epicurus, whose followers did not believe omens. Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread. Dialogue: Before battle the two sides trade insults; Brutus and Cassius say farewell "for ever and for ever." Characterization: Cassius, an Epicurean who scorned omens, now half believes them; it is his birthday. Watch for omens and portents: Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: "mind. But this same day / Must end that work the ides of March begun; / And whether we shall meet again I know" (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words" (Act V, Scene I, Antony (speech 16)). Antony's taunt about rhetoric. That is dialogue at work: Before battle the two sides trade insults; Brutus and Cassius say farewell "for ever and for ever."

> *In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words* (Act V, Scene I, Antony (speech 16))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words" (Act V, Scene I, Antony (speech 16)). Antony's taunt about rhetoric. That is dialogue at work: Before battle the two sides trade insults; Brutus and Cassius say farewell "for ever and for ever."

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The farewell foreshadows death; the birthday makes his death circular. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens? Expected: The eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. (Brutus's farewell.)

> *Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius* (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The farewell foreshadows death; the birthday makes his death circular.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens?
Expected answer: The eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. (Brutus's farewell.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about parley before battle? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of parley before battle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. When the text says “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)), it shows this directly. Brutus's "Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius" is a final goodbye, and Cassius notes "This is my birth-day."
Task: Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about parley before battle? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of parley before battle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. When the text says “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)), it shows this directly. Brutus's "Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius" is a final goodbye, and Cassius notes "This is my birth-day."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How do people prepare to face something they may not survive? Ask: what has changed in Cassius since Act I?
Anchor question: How do people prepare to face something they may not survive?
Facilitation: Ask: what has changed in Cassius since Act I?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about parley before battle? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. (“Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius”, Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about parley before battle? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. (“Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius”, Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how dialogue shapes parley before battle. Key takeaway: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dialogue:** Before battle the two sides trade insults; Brutus and Cassius say farewell "for ever and for ever."
- **Characterization:** Cassius, an Epicurean who scorned omens, now half believes them; it is his birthday.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites.

Symbols and motifs

- **omens and portents:** Storms, dreams and the soothsayer's warning raise the question of fate versus free will. In this scene: “mind. But this same day / Must end that work the ides of March begun; / And whether we shall meet again I know” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)).
- **honour:** "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “of thy strain, / Young man, thou couldst not die more honourable” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 25)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony (speech 16)) Antony's taunt about rhetoric.
- “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)) Brutus's farewell.
- “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius (speech 34)) Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle.
Evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41))
Reasoning: Brutus's "Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius" is a final goodbye, and Cassius notes "This is my birth-day."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

stomachs (noun)	courage; appetite for battle	*Defiance, traitors, hurl we in your teeth: If you dare fight to-day, come to the field; If not, when you have stomachs.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
presage (verb)	to foretell	*You know that I held Epicurus strong And his opinion: now I change my mind, And partly credit things that do presage.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
avenged (verb)	paid back with punishment	*Never, till Caesar's three and thirty wounds Be well avenged; or till another Caesar Have added slaughter to the sword of traitors.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
posture (noun)	stance; manner of attack	*Antony, The posture of your blows are yet unknown; But for your words, they rob the Hybla bees, And leave them honeyless.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
arguing (noun)	debating; quarreling	*Come, come, the cause: if arguing make us sweat, The proof of it will turn to redder drops.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
overthrow (noun)	defeat	*Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
envenomed (adjective)	poisoned	*Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
engender (verb)	to give rise to	*O error, soon conceived, Thou never comest unto a happy birth, But kill'st the mother that engender'd thee!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How do people prepare to face something they may not survive?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate, omens and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How many wounds does Octavius say Caesar received? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Three and thirty.
2. Where does the battle take place? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Philippi
3. What does Cassius tell Messala about this day? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It is his birthday
4. Which birds does Cassius say have replaced the eagles? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Ravens, crows and kites
5. Whose philosophy had Cassius followed? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Epicurus
6. What does Brutus say he will never do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Go bound to Rome as a captive
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: At Philippi, Octavius notes the enemy has come down to fight. The generals meet and exchange insults: Antony mocks the conspirators' flattery of Caesar; Cassius reminds Brutus he should have killed Antony. Octavius refuses to give way to Antony's order on the field. Cassius tells Messala it is his birthday and that he now half believes in omens: eagles have left their banners and ravens fly…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Defiance, traitors, hurl we in your teeth: If you dare fight to-day, come to the field; If not, when you have stomachs." What does "stomachs" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: stomachs: courage; appetite for battle.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Octavius's refusal to take Antony's command suggest about the future? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: He will not be Antony's junior; he will rise to rule.
2. What does "Act V, Scene I" suggest about parley before battle? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about parley before battle? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: "In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words" (Act V, Scene I, Antony (speech 16)): Antony's taunt about rhetoric. On characterization: Cassius, an Epicurean who

scorned omens, now half believes them; it is his birthday. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Come, come, the cause: if arguing make us sweat, The proof of it will turn to redder drops.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: At Philippi, Octavius notes the enemy has come down to fight. The generals meet and exchange insults: Antony mocks the conspirators' flattery of Caesar; Cassius reminds Brutus he should have killed Antony. Octavius refuses to give way to Antony's order on the field. Cassius tells Messala it is his…
7. How does “Act V, Scene I” build on “Act IV, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)): Brutus's farewell. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius (speech 34)): Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death. On characterization: Cassius, an Epicurean who scorned omens, now half believes them; it is his birthday. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do people prepare to face something they may not survive?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate, omens and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony (speech 16)): Antony's taunt about rhetoric. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Brutus's and Cassius's farewells are tender. Does that change how you judge them? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Accept answers on friendship versus political guilt.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat

even before the battle. Useful evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)): Brutus's farewell. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius (speech 34)): Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony (speech 16)): Antony's taunt about rhetoric. On characterization: Cassius, an Epicurean who scorned omens, now half believes them; it is his birthday. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of parley before battle. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)): Brutus's farewell. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius (speech 34)): Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to power, ambition and tyranny: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I,

Antony (speech 16)): Antony's taunt about rhetoric. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)): Brutus's farewell. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene I” treats parley before battle with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “This is my birth-day; as this very day / Was Cassius born” (Act V, Scene I, Cassius (speech 34)): Cassius notes it is his birthday: the day of birth may be the day of death. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “In your bad strokes, Brutus, you give good words” (Act V, Scene I, Antony (speech 16)): Antony's taunt about rhetoric. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about parley before battle? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The parley shows the conspirators preparing for defeat even before the battle. Useful evidence: “Forever, and forever, farewell, Cassius” (Act V, Scene I, Brutus (speech 41)): Brutus's farewell. Theme link: the eagles that followed them have flown, replaced by ravens and kites. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz

1. Where does the battle take place?
   A. Sardis
   B. Philippi
   C. Rome
   D. Actium
2. What does Cassius tell Messala about this day?
   A. It is Portia's birthday
   B. It is his birthday
   C. It is a holy day
   D. It is the ides of March
3. Which birds does Cassius say have replaced the eagles?
   A. Swans
   B. Doves
   C. Ravens, crows and kites
   D. Owls
4. Whose philosophy had Cassius followed?
   A. Epicurus
   B. Zeno
   C. Plato
   D. Socrates
5. What does Brutus say he will never do?
   A. Read the will
   B. Forgive Cassius
   C. Fight Antony
   D. Go bound to Rome as a captive
6. In the line "Defiance, traitors, hurl we in your teeth: If you dare fight to-day, come to the field; If not, when you have stomachs.", what does "stomachs" most nearly mean?
   A. to foretell
   B. paid back with punishment
   C. stance; manner of attack
   D. courage; appetite for battle
7. In the line "You know that I held Epicurus strong And his opinion: now I change my mind, And partly credit things that do presage.", what does "presage" most nearly mean?
   A. paid back with punishment
   B. stance; manner of attack
   C. courage; appetite for battle
   D. to foretell

Answer key: 1. B (Philippi); 2. B (It is his birthday); 3. C (Ravens, crows and kites); 4. A (Epicurus); 5. D (Go bound to Rome as a captive); 6. D (courage; appetite for battle); 7. D (to foretell)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene I," how does Shakespeare show parley before battle? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of parley before battle? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of parley before battle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of parley before battle. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene I suggests about parley before battle. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act V, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of parley before battle. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of parley before battle responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of parley before battle follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene I and its treatment of parley before battle. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about parley before battle in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of parley before battle. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Never, till Caesar's three and thirty wounds Be well avenged; or till another Caesar Have added slaughter to the sword of traitors.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "avenged" most nearly mean?

   A. paid back with punishment

   B. to give rise to

   C. poisoned

   D. defeat

2. *Come, come, the cause: if arguing make us sweat, The proof of it will turn to redder drops. Look; I draw a sword against conspirators; When think you that the sword goes up again? Never, till Caesar's three and thirty wounds Be well avenged; or till another Caesar Have added slaughter to the sword of traitors.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene I"?

   A. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

   B. Parley before battle

   C. Portia's anxiety

   D. Storm, omens and recruitment

SAT key: 1. A (paid back with punishment); 2. B (Parley before battle)

Lesson 17: Act V, Scene II

Focus: the first charge

Teacher only · spoilers

Brutus sends Messala with written orders for his legions to charge at once, because he sees coldness in Octavius's wing and hopes a sudden attack will overthrow it.

Background: Act V, Scene II is one of the shortest scenes in Shakespeare, a quick cut in battle.

Significance: Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because....
Prompt: How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Brutus's haste.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: overthrow — defeat; envenomed — poisoned; engender — to give rise to; garland — a wreath worn as a sign of victory; revenged — avenged.
Words: overthrow: defeat · envenomed: poisoned · engender: to give rise to · garland: a wreath worn as a sign of victory · revenged: avenged

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Act V, Scene II is one of the shortest scenes in Shakespeare, a quick cut in battle. Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield. Structure: A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack. Pacing: Short scenes speed up the battle. Watch for warnings ignored: Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: "Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills / Unto the legions on the other side. Loud alarum. / Let them" (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)). Haste. That is structure at work: A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack.

> *Let them set on at once (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1))*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)). Haste. That is structure at work: A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Repetition ("ride, ride") shows haste.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens? Expected: Brutus's haste. (Urgency.)

> *Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1))*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Repetition ("ride, ride") shows haste.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens?
Expected answer: Brutus's haste. (Urgency.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for structure, pacing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the first charge? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the first charge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. When the text says “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)), it shows this directly. "Let them set on at once," he orders.
Task: Annotate the scene for structure, pacing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the first charge? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the first charge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. When the text says “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)), it shows this directly. "Let them set on at once," he orders.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle? Ask: why are battle scenes so short in Shakespeare?
Anchor question: How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle?
Facilitation: Ask: why are battle scenes so short in Shakespeare?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the first charge? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. (“Let them set on at once”, Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the first charge? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. (“Let them set on at once”, Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes the first charge. Key takeaway: Brutus's haste.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack.
- **Pacing:** Short scenes speed up the battle.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** Brutus's haste.

Symbols and motifs

- **warnings ignored:** Letters, papers and messages repeatedly warn or move characters, and are repeatedly ignored or misread. In this scene: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills / Unto the legions on the other side. Loud alarum. / Let them” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)) Urgency.
- “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)) Haste.

- “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)) Brutus's hope.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy.
Evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1))
Reasoning: "Let them set on at once," he orders.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
overthrow (noun)	defeat	*Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
envenomed (adjective)	poisoned	*Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
engender (verb)	to give rise to	*O error, soon conceived, Thou never comest unto a happy birth, But kill'st the mother that engender'd thee!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
garland (noun)	a wreath worn as a sign of victory	*But, hold thee, take this garland on thy brow; Thy Brutus bid me give it thee, and I Will do his bidding.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
revenged (adjective)	avenged	*Caesar, thou art revenged, Even with the sword that kill'd thee.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
freeman (noun)	a free person, no longer a slave	*Come now, keep thine oath; Now be a freeman: and with this good sword, That ran through Caesar's bowels, search this bosom.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bondman (noun)	a slave	*All disconsolate, With Pindarus his bondman, on this hill.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
villains (noun)	base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers)	*O, look, Titinius, look, the villains fly!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle?
2. Where does structure appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Brutus want his legions to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Set on (charge) at once.
2. Whom does Brutus send with the orders? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Messala
3. Which wing of the enemy does Brutus plan to attack? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Octavius's
4. Why does Brutus think the attack will work? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He sees coldness in Octavius's wing
5. How does Brutus send his instructions? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Written bills
6. How long is this scene compared with others? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Very short
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Brutus sends Messala with written orders for his legions to charge at once, because he sees coldness in Octavius's wing and hopes a sudden attack will overthrow it.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow." What does "overthrow" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: overthrow: defeat.

Inferential / analytical

1. What can you infer about Brutus's mood from this brief scene? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Urgent, hopeful, perhaps rash.
2. What does "Act V, Scene II" suggest about the first charge? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield.

3. Find one example of structure in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about the first charge? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Urgency. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills Unto the legions on the other side.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Brutus sends Messala with written orders for his legions to charge at once, because he sees coldness in Octavius's wing and hopes a sudden attack will overthrow it.
7. How does “Act V, Scene II” build on “Act V, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Haste. On structure: A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Brutus's hope. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Urgency. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Why might Shakespeare break the battle into many short scenes rather than one long one? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Pacing, confusion, multiple viewpoints.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Haste. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Brutus's hope. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Urgency. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the first charge. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Haste. On structure: A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Brutus's hope. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Urgency. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the structure in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Haste. On structure: A three-line scene: Brutus sends Messala with orders to attack. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene II” treats the first charge with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “sudden push gives them the overthrow” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Brutus's hope. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Urgency. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the first charge? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brutus's urgency reflects his "tide" philosophy. Useful evidence: “Let them set on at once” (Act V, Scene II, Brutus (speech 1)): Haste. Theme link: Brutus's haste. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Whom does Brutus send with the orders?

   A. Titinius

   B. Messala

   C. Pindarus

   D. Lucilius

2. Which wing of the enemy does Brutus plan to attack?
   A. Octavius's
   B. Cassius's
   C. Antony's
   D. Lepidus's
3. Why does Brutus think the attack will work?
   A. The gods favor him
   B. He sees coldness in Octavius's wing
   C. Antony is ill
   D. Cassius told him
4. How does Brutus send his instructions?
   A. A trumpet signal
   B. Written bills
   C. A messenger bird
   D. A shouted command
5. How long is this scene compared with others?
   A. About average
   B. It has no lines
   C. The longest in the play
   D. Very short
6. In the line “Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius’ wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow.”, what does “overthrow” most nearly mean?
   A. a wreath worn as a sign of victory
   B. to give rise to
   C. defeat
   D. poisoned
7. In the line “Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight.”, what does “envenomed” most nearly mean?
   A. defeat
   B. poisoned
   C. to give rise to
   D. a wreath worn as a sign of victory

Answer key: 1. B (Messala); 2. A (Octavius's); 3. B (He sees coldness in Octavius's wing); 4. B (Written bills); 5. D (Very short); 6. C (defeat); 7. B (poisoned)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene

II," how does Shakespeare show the first charge? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the first charge? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the first charge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the first charge. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene II suggests about the first charge. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's structure and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses structure in Act V, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the first charge. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the first charge responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the first charge follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene II and its treatment of the first charge. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's structure and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the first charge in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the first charge. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *O error, soon conceived, Thou never comest unto a happy birth, But kill'st the mother that engender'd thee!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "engender" most nearly mean?

   A. a free person, no longer a slave

   B. base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers)

   C. to give rise to

   D. a slave

2. *Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills Unto the legions on the other side. Loud alarum. Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow. Ride, ride, Messala: let them all come down. Exeunt.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene II"?

   A. Young Cato and Lucilius

   B. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

   C. The first charge

   D. Storm, omens and recruitment

SAT key: 1. C (to give rise to); 2. C (The first charge)

Lesson 18: Act V, Scene III

Focus: the death of Cassius

Content note (suicide): Cassius and Titinius take their own lives after a misunderstanding. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss Roman honor codes critically and the role of misinformation, not methods.
Student preview: This scene shows two deaths by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: "How did a mistake lead to this outcome?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Cassius's men are fleeing; Brutus's troops have charged too early and turned to looting. Cassius sends Titinius to see whether nearby troops are friend or foe and asks Pindarus to watch. Pindarus mistakenly reports Titinius captured. Believing all lost, Cassius has Pindarus stab him with the sword that killed Caesar: 'Caesar, thou art revenged.' Titinius returns with a victory garland from Brutus, finds Cassius dead, and kills himself. Brutus arrives, mourns Cassius as 'the last of all the Romans' and resolves to fight again.

Background: Plutarch reports that Cassius died on his birthday, killed by his freedman Pindarus at his own command, after misreading the battle.

Significance: A death built on misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and omens because.... Content note before we start: This scene shows two deaths by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and omens because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Caesar's spirit seems to win.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: envenomed — poisoned; engender — to give rise to; garland — a wreath worn as a sign of victory; revenged — avenged; freeman — a free person, no longer a slave.
Words: envenomed: poisoned · engender: to give rise to · garland: a wreath worn as a sign of victory · revenged: avenged · freeman: a free person, no longer a slave

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plutarch reports that Cassius died on his birthday, killed by his freedman Pindarus at his own command, after misreading the battle. A death built on misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students. Dramatic irony: Cassius misreads Titinius's capture (actually a welcome) and has Pindarus kill him. Characterization: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!" Watch for blood: Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: "red rays thou dost sink to-night, / So in his red blood Cassius' day is set; / The sun of Rome is set! Our" (Act V, Scene III, Titinius (speech 21)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill'd thee" (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 12)). Cassius's death. That is dramatic irony at work: Cassius misreads Titinius's capture (actually a welcome) and has Pindarus kill him.

> *Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill'd thee* (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 12))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill'd thee" (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 12)). Cassius's death. That is dramatic irony at work: Cassius misreads Titinius's capture (actually a welcome) and has Pindarus kill him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Brutus. Look at the craft: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!" Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens? Expected: Caesar's spirit seems to win. (Brutus.)

> *O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet* (Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Brutus. Look at the craft: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!"
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and omens?
Expected answer: Caesar's spirit seems to win. (Brutus.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the death of Cassius? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the death of Cassius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. When the text says "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet" (Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30)), it shows this directly. Titinius laments "thou hast misconstrued everything," and Brutus sees Caesar "mighty yet."
Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the death of Cassius? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the death of Cassius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. When the text says "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet" (Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30)), it shows this directly. Titinius laments "thou hast misconstrued everything," and Brutus sees Caesar "mighty yet."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster? Content note: suicide. Ask how the play frames Roman suicide.
Anchor question: How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster?
Facilitation: Content note: suicide. Ask how the play frames Roman suicide.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the death of Cassius? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. ("O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet", Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the death of Cassius? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. ("O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet", Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes the death of Cassius. Key takeaway: Caesar's spirit seems to win.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Cassius misreads Titinius's capture (actually a welcome) and has Pindarus kill him.
- **Characterization:** Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!"

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and omens:** Caesar's spirit seems to win.

Symbols and motifs

- **blood:** Blood turns the assassination from sacrifice into butchery; the conspirators bathe their hands in it. In this scene: “red rays thou dost sink to-night, / So in his red blood Cassius’ day is set; / The sun of Rome is set! Our” (Act V, Scene III, Titinius (speech 21)).
- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: “Cassius, / Far from this country Pindarus shall run, / Where never Roman shall take note of him. Exit” (Act V, Scene III, Pindarus (speech 13)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 12)) Cassius's death.
- “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30)) Brutus.
- “Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything” (Act V, Scene III, Titinius (speech 25)) Titinius.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I.
Evidence: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30))
Reasoning: Titinius laments "thou hast misconstrued everything," and Brutus sees Caesar "mighty yet."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
envenomed (adjective)	poisoned	*Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
engender (verb)	to give rise to	*O error, soon conceived, Thou never comest unto a happy birth, But kill’st the mother that engender’d thee!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
garland (noun)	a wreath worn as a sign of victory	*But, hold thee, take this garland on thy brow; Thy Brutus bid me give it thee, and I Will do his bidding.*	

			Student look-up (not yet verified)
revenged (adjective)	avenged	*Caesar, thou art revenged, Even with the sword that kill'd thee.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
freeman (noun)	a free person, no longer a slave	*Come now, keep thine oath; Now be a freeman: and with this good sword, That ran through Caesar's bowels, search this bosom.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bondman (noun)	a slave	*All disconsolate, With Pindarus his bondman, on this hill.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
villains (noun)	base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers)	*O, look, Titinius, look, the villains fly!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
entrails (noun)	internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)	*Thy spirit walks abroad, and turns our swords In our own proper entrails.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What reward does Cassius promise Pindarus for killing him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His freedom.
2. What does Pindarus mistakenly report? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: That Titinius has been captured
3. With what does Cassius ask to be killed? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The sword that killed Caesar
4. What does Titinius bring back for Cassius? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A wreath of victory from Brutus

5. What does Brutus call Cassius? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The last of all the Romans
6. What does Brutus say Caesar's spirit does? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Turns their swords against themselves
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act V, Scene III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Cassius's men are fleeing; Brutus's troops have charged too early and turned to looting. Cassius sends Titinius to see whether nearby troops are friend or foe and asks Pindarus to watch. Pindarus mistakenly reports Titinius captured. Believing all lost, Cassius has Pindarus stab him with the sword that killed Caesar: 'Caesar, thou art revenged.' Titinius returns with a victory garland from…
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act V, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this…” What does “envenomed” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: envenomed: poisoned.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Cassius believe Pindarus without checking? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Despair and his birthday omens; he expects defeat.
2. What does “Act V, Scene III” suggest about the death of Cassius? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A death built on misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the death of Cassius? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 12)): Cassius's death. On characterization: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Come hither, sirrah: In Parthia did I take thee prisoner; And then I swore thee, saving of thy life, That whatsoever I did bid thee do, Thou shouldst attempt it.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Cassius's men are fleeing; Brutus's troops have charged too early

and turned to looting. Cassius sends Titinius to see whether nearby troops are friend or foe and asks Pindarus to watch. Pindarus mistakenly reports Titinius captured. Believing all lost, Cassius has Pindarus stab him with the sword…

7. How does “Act V, Scene III” build on “Act V, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30)): Brutus. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything” (Act V, Scene III, Titinius (speech 25)): Titinius. On characterization: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 12)): Cassius's death. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Cassius's death noble in the Roman sense or simply tragic? Discuss with care for the topic. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Discuss Roman honor codes vs. a modern view; use safe messaging.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30)): Brutus. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “A death built on misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything” (Act V, Scene III,

Titinius (speech 25)): Titinius. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 12)): Cassius's death. On characterization: Titinius kills himself in grief; Brutus mourns: "O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the death of Cassius. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30)): Brutus. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything” (Act V, Scene III, Titinius (speech 25)): Titinius. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 12)): Cassius's death. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30)): Brutus. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene III” treats the death of Cassius with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Alas, thou hast misconstrued everything” (Act V, Scene III,

Titinius (speech 25)): Titinius. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “Caesar, thou art revenged, / Even with the sword that kill’d thee” (Act V, Scene III, speech (speech 12)): Cassius's death. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the death of Cassius? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Cassius's death results from misreading, echoing Cicero's warning in Act I. Useful evidence: “O Julius Caesar, thou art mighty yet” (Act V, Scene III, Brutus (speech 30)): Brutus. Theme link: Caesar's spirit seems to win. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What does Pindarus mistakenly report?
   A. That Titinius has been captured
   B. That Brutus is dead
   C. That Rome is burning
   D. That Antony has fled
2. With what does Cassius ask to be killed?
   A. Poison
   B. The sword that killed Caesar
   C. A spear
   D. Fire
3. What does Titinius bring back for Cassius?
   A. Antony's sword
   B. A letter from Portia
   C. A wreath of victory from Brutus
   D. A crown

4. What does Brutus call Cassius?
   A. A traitor
   B. The last of all the Romans
   C. His enemy
   D. A coward
5. What does Brutus say Caesar's spirit does?
   A. Forgives them
   B. Haunts Antony
   C. Protects Rome
   D. Turns their swords against themselves
6. In the line "Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight.", what does "envenomed" most nearly mean?
   A. a wreath worn as a sign of victory
   B. poisoned
   C. avenged
   D. to give rise to
7. In the line "O error, soon conceived, Thou never comest unto a happy birth, But kill'st the mother that engender'd thee!", what does "engender" most nearly mean?
   A. a wreath worn as a sign of victory
   B. avenged
   C. to give rise to
   D. poisoned

Answer key: 1. A (That Titinius has been captured); 2. B (The sword that killed Caesar); 3. C (A wreath of victory from Brutus); 4. B (The last of all the Romans); 5. D (Turns their swords against themselves); 6. B (poisoned); 7. C (to give rise to)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene III," how does Shakespeare show the death of Cassius? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the death of Cassius? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the death of Cassius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and

explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the death of Cassius. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene III suggests about the death of Cassius. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act V, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the death of Cassius. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the death of Cassius responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the death of Cassius follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene III and its treatment of the death of Cassius. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the death of Cassius in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the death of Cassius. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *But, hold thee, take this garland on thy brow; Thy Brutus bid me give it thee, and I Will do his bidding.*

As used in the text, what does the word "garland" most nearly mean?

A. a slave

B. internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)

C. a wreath worn as a sign of victory

D. base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers)

2. *Come hither, sirrah: In Parthia did I take thee prisoner; And then I swore thee, saving of thy life, That whatsoever I did bid thee do, Thou shouldst attempt it. Come now, keep thine oath; Now be a freeman: and with this good sword, That ran through Caesar's bowels, search this bosom. Stand not to answer: here, take thou the hilts; And, when my face is cover'd, as 'tis now, Guide thou the sword. Pindarus stabs him. Caesar, thou art revenged, Even with the sword that kill'd thee. Dies.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene III"?

A. The death of Cassius

B. The first charge

C. Parley before battle

D. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

SAT key: 1. C (a wreath worn as a sign of victory); 2. A (The death of Cassius)

Lesson 19: Act V, Scene IV

Focus: young Cato and Lucilius

Teacher only · spoilers

Young Cato, Portia's brother, proclaims his name and is killed. Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him and is captured. Antony recognizes the trick, orders that Lucilius be treated kindly, and says he would rather have such men as friends than enemies.

Background: Young Cato was the son of Cato the Younger, a famous defender of the republic, and the brother of Portia.

Significance: Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to friendship and loyalty because....
Prompt: What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to friendship and loyalty because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Lucilius's loyalty.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tyrants — cruel and unjust rulers; kindness — kind treatment; proclaim — to declare publicly; chanced — happened; tarrying — staying; lingering.
Words: tyrants: cruel and unjust rulers · kindness: kind treatment · proclaim: to declare publicly · chanced: happened · tarrying: staying; lingering

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Young Cato was the son of Cato the Younger, a famous defender of the republic, and the brother of Portia. Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat. Characterization: Young Cato dies fighting; Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him. Characterization: Antony treats Lucilius with respect. Watch for honour: "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “now thou diest as bravely as Titinius; / And mayst be honour’d, being Cato’s son” (Act V, Scene IV, Lucilius (speech 4)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho" (Act V, Scene IV, Cato (speech 2)). Young Cato. That is characterization at work: Young Cato dies fighting; Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him.

> *I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho* (Act V, Scene IV, Cato (speech 2))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho" (Act V, Scene IV, Cato (speech 2)). Young Cato. That is characterization at work: Young Cato dies fighting; Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Lucilius's disguise. Look at the craft: Antony treats Lucilius with respect. Ask: How does this line connect to friendship and loyalty? Expected: Lucilius's loyalty. (Lucilius's disguise.)

> *Brutus, my country's friend; know me for Brutus* (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus (speech 3))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Lucilius's disguise. Look at the craft: Antony treats Lucilius with respect.
Ask: How does this line connect to friendship and loyalty?
Expected answer: Lucilius's loyalty. (Lucilius's disguise.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about young Cato and Lucilius? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene IV develops the idea of young Cato and Lucilius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. When the text says "I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies" (Act V, Scene IV, Antony (speech 12)), it shows this directly. He cries "know me for Brutus," and Antony says he would "rather have / Such men my friends than enemies."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about young Cato and Lucilius? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene IV develops the idea of young Cato and Lucilius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. When the text says "I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies" (Act V, Scene IV, Antony (speech 12)), it shows this directly. He cries "know me for Brutus," and Antony says he would "rather have / Such men my friends than enemies."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing? Ask: what does this scene show about Brutus?
Anchor question: What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing?
Facilitation: Ask: what does this scene show about Brutus?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about young Cato and Lucilius? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. ("I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies", Act V, Scene IV, Antony (speech 12)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about young Cato and Lucilius? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. ("I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies", Act V, Scene IV, Antony (speech 12)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes young Cato and Lucilius. Key takeaway: Lucilius's loyalty.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Young Cato dies fighting; Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him.
- **Characterization:** Antony treats Lucilius with respect.

Themes and how they develop

- **friendship and loyalty:** Lucilius's loyalty.

Symbols and motifs

- **honour:** "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: "now thou diest as bravely as Titinius; / And mayst be honour'd, being Cato's son" (Act V, Scene IV, Lucilius (speech 4)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho" (Act V, Scene IV, Cato (speech 2)) Young Cato.
- "Brutus, my country's friend; know me for Brutus" (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus (speech 3)) Lucilius's disguise.

- “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony (speech 12)) Antony's respect.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires.
Evidence: “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony (speech 12))
Reasoning: He cries "know me for Brutus," and Antony says he would "rather have / Such men my friends than enemies."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tyrants (noun)	cruel and unjust rulers	*A foe to tyrants, and my country's friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
kindness (noun)	kind treatment	*This is not Brutus, friend; but, I assure you, A prize no less in worth: keep this man safe; Give him all kindness: I had rather have Such men my friends than enemies.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
proclaim (verb)	to declare publicly	*I will proclaim my name about the field: I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chanced (verb)	happened	*Go on, And see whether Brutus be alive or dead; And bring us word unto Octavius' tent How everything is chanced.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tarrying (verb)	staying; lingering	*Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
slaying (noun)	killing	*Sit thee down, Clitus: slaying is the word; It is a deed in fashion.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bondage (noun)	slavery; captivity	*Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The conquerors can but make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath honour by his death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
entertain (verb)	to take into service	*All that served Brutus, I will entertain them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23,

24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Lucilius say about Brutus being taken alive? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: No enemy shall ever take noble Brutus alive.
2. Who pretends to be Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lucilius
3. Why does Lucilius pretend to be Brutus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To protect him
4. Who recognizes the trick? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Antony
5. How does Antony order Lucilius to be treated? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Kindly
6. Whose son is young Cato? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Cato the Younger's
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Young Cato, Portia's brother, proclaims his name and is killed. Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him and is captured. Antony recognizes the trick, orders that Lucilius be treated kindly, and says he would rather have such men as friends than enemies.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "A foe to tyrants, and my country's friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!" What does "tyrants" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: tyrants: cruel and unjust rulers.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Antony value Lucilius? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: His loyalty would make him a valuable friend.
2. What does "Act V, Scene IV" suggest about young Cato and Lucilius? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about young Cato and Lucilius? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: "I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho" (Act V, Scene IV, Cato (speech 2)): Young Cato. Theme

link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “What bastard doth not?”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Young Cato, Portia's brother, proclaims his name and is killed. Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him and is captured. Antony recognizes the trick, orders that Lucilius be treated kindly, and says he would rather have such men as friends than enemies.
7. How does “Act V, Scene IV” build on “Act V, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus (speech 3)): Lucilius's disguise. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony (speech 12)): Antony's respect. On characterization: Antony treats Lucilius with respect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato (speech 2)): Young Cato. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Lucilius's deception admirable even though it is a lie? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Weigh loyalty against honesty.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus (speech 3)): Lucilius's disguise. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 ·

fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony (speech 12)): Antony's respect. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato (speech 2)): Young Cato. On characterization: Antony treats Lucilius with respect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of young Cato and Lucilius. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus (speech 3)): Lucilius's disguise. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony (speech 12)): Antony's respect. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato (speech 2)): Young Cato. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus (speech 3)): Lucilius's disguise. On characterization: Antony treats Lucilius with respect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene IV” treats young Cato and Lucilius with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires.

Useful evidence: “I had rather have / Such men my friends than enemies” (Act V, Scene IV, Antony (speech 12)): Antony's respect. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene V” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho” (Act V, Scene IV, Cato (speech 2)): Young Cato. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about young Cato and Lucilius? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lucilius's sacrifice shows the loyalty Brutus inspires. Useful evidence: “Brutus, my country’s friend; know me for Brutus” (Act V, Scene IV, Brutus (speech 3)): Lucilius's disguise. Theme link: Lucilius's loyalty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Who pretends to be Brutus?
   A. Messala
   B. Lucilius
   C. Titinius
   D. Cato
2. Why does Lucilius pretend to be Brutus?
   A. To flee
   B. To trick Cassius
   C. To win a reward
   D. To protect him
3. Who recognizes the trick?
   A. Octavius
   B. Antony
   C. Lepidus
   D. Pindarus

4. How does Antony order Lucilius to be treated?
   A. Executed
   B. Imprisoned harshly
   C. Kindly
   D. Sent away
5. Whose son is young Cato?
   A. Cato the Younger's
   B. Caesar's
   C. Brutus's
   D. Cicero's
6. In the line “A foe to tyrants, and my country’s friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!”, what does “tyrants” most nearly mean?
   A. happened
   B. cruel and unjust rulers
   C. to declare publicly
   D. kind treatment
7. In the line “This is not Brutus, friend; but, I assure you, A prize no less in worth: keep this man safe; Give him all kindness: I had rather have Such men my friends than enemies.”, what does “kindness” most nearly mean?
   A. happened
   B. kind treatment
   C. cruel and unjust rulers
   D. to declare publicly

Answer key: 1. B (Lucilius); 2. D (To protect him); 3. B (Antony); 4. C (Kindly); 5. A (Cato the Younger's); 6. B (cruel and unjust rulers); 7. B (kind treatment)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show young Cato and Lucilius? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of young Cato and Lucilius? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene IV develops the idea of young Cato and Lucilius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of young Cato and Lucilius. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene IV suggests about young Cato and Lucilius. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act V, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of young Cato and Lucilius. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of young Cato and Lucilius responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of young Cato and Lucilius follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene IV and its treatment of young Cato and Lucilius. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about young Cato and Lucilius in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of young Cato and Lucilius. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *I will proclaim my name about the field: I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!*

   As used in the text, what does the word “proclaim” most nearly mean?

   A. to declare publicly

B. slavery; captivity

C. to take into service

D. killing

2. *What bastard doth not? Who will go with me? I will proclaim my name about the field: I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho! A foe to tyrants, and my country's friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene IV"?

A. The triumvirs' proscription list

B. Calpurnia's dream

C. Young Cato and Lucilius

D. Brutus and Cassius at odds

SAT key: 1. A (to declare publicly); 2. C (Young Cato and Lucilius)

Lesson 20: Act V, Scene V

Focus: the death of Brutus

Content note (suicide): Brutus dies by suicide with Strato's help. Use the safe-messaging script; keep focus on Antony's verdict and the play's questions about honor.
Student preview: This scene shows a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: "Is Antony's final judgment of Brutus fair?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Defeated, Brutus asks Clitus, Dardanius and Volumnius in turn to help him die; all refuse. He tells them Caesar's ghost appeared to him again at Philippi. Strato holds his sword and Brutus runs on it, saying 'Caesar, now be still: I kill'd not thee with half so good a will.' Antony and Octavius arrive. Antony calls Brutus 'the noblest Roman of them all,' the only conspirator who acted for the common good, not envy. Octavius orders an honorable burial and ends the play.

Background: Plutarch reports that Brutus died by his own hand after Philippi, assisted by Strato, in 42 BC. Octavius later became Augustus, Rome's first emperor, ending the republic Brutus tried to save.

Significance: The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can a person be noble and still be wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to honour and idealism because.... Content note before we start: This scene shows a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Can a person be noble and still be wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to honour and idealism because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Brutus's honour recognized.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tarrying — staying; lingering; slaying — killing; bondage — slavery; captivity; entertain — to take into service; elements — the basic qualities that make up a person.
Words: tarrying: staying; lingering · slaying: killing · bondage: slavery; captivity · entertain: to take into service · elements: the basic qualities that make up a person

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plutarch reports that Brutus died by his own hand after Philippi, assisted by Strato, in 42 BC. Octavius later became Augustus, Rome's first emperor, ending the republic Brutus tried to save. The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support. Characterization: Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword. Structure: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all." Watch for honour: "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “a good respect; / Thy life hath had some smatch of honour in it: / Hold then my sword, and turn away thy face” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus (speech 23)).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus (speech 25)). Brutus's last words. That is characterization at work: Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword.

> *Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will* (Act V, Scene V, Brutus (speech 25))

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus (speech 25)). Brutus's last words. That is characterization at work: Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Antony's tribute. Look at the craft: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all." Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism? Expected: Brutus's honour recognized. (Antony's tribute.)

> *This was the noblest Roman of them all* (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36))

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Antony's tribute. Look at the craft: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all."
Ask: How does this line connect to honour and idealism?
Expected answer: Brutus's honour recognized. (Antony's tribute.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the death of Brutus? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of the death of Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. When the text says "This was the noblest Roman of them all" (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)), it shows this directly. Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all," and Brutus's last words, "I kill'd not thee with half so good a will," admit his reluctance.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the death of Brutus? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of the death of Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. When the text says "This was the noblest Roman of them all" (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)), it shows this directly. Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all," and Brutus's last words, "I kill'd not thee with half so good a will," admit his reluctance.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can a person be noble and still be wrong? Ask: is Brutus the tragic hero?
Anchor question: Can a person be noble and still be wrong?
Facilitation: Ask: is Brutus the tragic hero?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the death of Brutus? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. ("This was the noblest Roman of them all", Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the death of Brutus? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. ("This was the noblest Roman of them all", Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the death of Brutus. Key takeaway: Brutus's honour recognized.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword.
- **Structure:** Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all."

Themes and how they develop

- **honour and idealism:** Brutus's honour recognized.

Symbols and motifs

- **honour:** "Honourable" is a key word; Antony turns it into irony in the funeral oration. In this scene: “a good respect; / Thy life hath had some smatch of honour in it: / Hold then my sword, and turn away thy face” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus (speech 23)).
- **Rome and the people:** The crowd's loyalty is fickle; speakers win Rome by moving the plebeians. In this scene: “This was the noblest Roman of them all: / All the conspirators save only he / Did that” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus (speech 25)) Brutus's last words.
- “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)) Antony's tribute.
- “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)) The ideal.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure.
Evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36))
Reasoning: Antony calls him "the noblest Roman of them all," and Brutus's last words, "I kill'd not thee with half so good a will," admit his reluctance.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tarrying (verb)	staying; lingering	*Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
slaying (noun)	killing	*Sit thee down, Clitus: slaying is the word; It is a deed in fashion.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bondage (noun)	slavery; captivity	*Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The conquerors can but make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath honour by his death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

entertain (verb)	to take into service	*All that served Brutus, I will entertain them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
elements (noun)	the basic qualities that make up a person	*His life was gentle, and the elements So mix'd in him that Nature might stand up And say to all the world "This was a man!"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
proclaim (verb)	to declare publicly	*I will proclaim my name about the field: I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tyrants (noun)	cruel and unjust rulers	*A foe to tyrants, and my country's friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chanced (verb)	happened	*Go on, And see whether Brutus be alive or dead; And bring us word unto Octavius' tent How everything is chanced.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Can a person be noble and still be wrong?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where did Caesar's ghost appear again to Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: In the fields of Philippi.
2. Who holds the sword for Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Strato
3. What does Brutus say to Caesar as he dies? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He killed Caesar with less good will than himself
4. What does Antony call Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The noblest Roman of them all
5. Why does Antony say Brutus was different from the other conspirators? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He acted for the common good, not envy
6. Who speaks the play's final lines? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Octavius
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Defeated, Brutus asks Clitus, Dardanius and Volumnius in turn to help him die; all refuse. He tells them Caesar's ghost appeared to him again at Philippi. Strato holds his sword and Brutus runs on it, saying 'Caesar, now be still: I kill'd not thee with half so good a will.' Antony and Octavius arrive. Antony calls Brutus 'the noblest Roman of them all,' the only conspirator who acted for the…

8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene V”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act V, Scene V” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here.” What does “tarrying” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: tarrying: staying; lingering.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why do Brutus's servants refuse to help him die? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Love and loyalty; they cannot bring themselves to do it.
2. What does “Act V, Scene V” suggest about the death of Brutus? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about the death of Brutus? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus (speech 25)): Brutus's last words. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “This was the noblest Roman of them all: All the conspirators save only he Did that they did in envy of great Caesar; He only, in a general honest thought And common good to all,…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Defeated, Brutus asks Clitus, Dardanius and Volumnius in turn to help him die; all refuse. He tells them Caesar's ghost appeared to him again at Philippi. Strato holds his sword and Brutus runs on it, saying 'Caesar, now be still: I kill'd not thee with half so good a will.' Antony and Octavius…
7. How does “Act V, Scene V” build on “Act V, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)): Antony's tribute. On structure: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)): The ideal. On characterization: Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can a person be noble and still be wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus (speech 25)): Brutus's last words. On structure: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Antony praises Brutus after doing everything to destroy him. Is the tribute sincere, political, or both? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Accept justified readings; note Octavius takes command.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)): Antony's tribute. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)): The ideal. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus (speech 25)): Brutus's last words. On characterization: Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the death of Brutus. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)): Antony's tribute. On structure: Antony's eulogy: "This was the noblest Roman of them all." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)): The ideal. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus (speech 25)): Brutus's last words. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)): Antony's tribute. On characterization: Brutus asks his servants to help him die; Strato holds the sword. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene V” treats the death of Brutus with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “the elements / So mix’d in him that Nature might stand up / And say to all the world “This was a man” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)): The ideal. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve public versus private self? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “Caesar, now be still: / I kill’d not thee with half so good a will” (Act V, Scene V, Brutus (speech 25)): Brutus's last words. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the death of Brutus? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play ends by honouring Brutus's motives while showing their failure. Useful evidence: “This was the noblest Roman of them all” (Act V, Scene V, Antony (speech 36)): Antony's tribute. Theme link: Brutus's honour recognized. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz

1. Who holds the sword for Brutus?
    A. Volumnius
    B. Clitus
    C. Strato
    D. Messala
2. What does Brutus say to Caesar as he dies?
    A. He forgives Caesar
    B. He will see him in Rome
    C. He killed Caesar with less good will than himself
    D. He was right
3. What does Antony call Brutus?
    A. A traitor
    B. A coward
    C. A fool
    D. The noblest Roman of them all
4. Why does Antony say Brutus was different from the other conspirators?
    A. He acted for the common good, not envy
    B. He planned the plot
    C. He was the bravest fighter
    D. He was Caesar's son

5. Who speaks the play's final lines?
   A. Strato
   B. Octavius
   C. Antony
   D. Lucilius
6. In the line “Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here.”, what does “tarrying” most nearly mean?
   A. staying; lingering
   B. killing
   C. slavery; captivity
   D. to take into service
7. In the line “Sit thee down, Clitus: slaying is the word; It is a deed in fashion.”, what does “slaying” most nearly mean?
   A. killing
   B. slavery; captivity
   C. staying; lingering
   D. to take into service

Answer key: 1. C (Strato); 2. C (He killed Caesar with less good will than himself); 3. D (The noblest Roman of them all); 4. A (He acted for the common good, not envy); 5. B (Octavius); 6. A (staying; lingering); 7. A (killing)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene V,” how does Shakespeare show the death of Brutus? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Act V, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the death of Brutus? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of the death of Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the death of Brutus. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene V suggests about the death of Brutus. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each

(including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act V, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of the death of Brutus. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the death of Brutus responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the death of Brutus follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene V and its treatment of the death of Brutus. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about the death of Brutus in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the death of Brutus. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

SAT-style questions

1. *Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The conquerors can but make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath honour by his death.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “bondage” most nearly mean?

   A. to declare publicly

   B. slavery; captivity

   C. cruel and unjust rulers

   D. happened

2. *This was the noblest Roman of them all: All the conspirators save only he Did that they did in envy of great Caesar; He only, in a general honest thought And common good to all, made one of them. His life was gentle, and the elements So mix'd in him that Nature might stand up And say to all the world "This was a man!"*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene V"?

A. Brutus and Cassius at odds

B. Cassius works on Brutus

C. The death of Brutus

D. Cinna the poet

SAT key: 1. B (slavery; captivity); 2. C (The death of Brutus)

Whole-book test

Julius Caesar: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. Who are the two women named in the cast list?
   A. Lucretia and Portia
   B. Calpurnia and Cleopatra
   C. Calpurnia and Portia
   D. Portia and Octavia
2. Why are the commoners out in the streets?
   A. To protest taxes
   B. To elect tribunes
   C. To celebrate Caesar's triumph
   D. To see a play
3. What does the soothsayer warn Caesar to beware?
   A. The Capitol
   B. Cassius
   C. The Lupercal
   D. The ides of March
4. What strange sight does Casca report about a slave's hand?
   A. It burned but was not scorched
   B. It held a crown
   C. It bled
   D. It turned to stone
5. To what does Brutus compare Caesar in his soliloquy?
   A. A serpent's egg
   B. A lion
   C. A falling star
   D. A storm
6. What did Calpurnia dream about Caesar's statue?
   A. It spouted blood that Romans bathed in
   B. It wept
   C. It turned to gold
   D. It fell and broke
7. What does Artemidorus's letter contain?
   A. A request for money

B. The names of the conspirators

C. A prophecy

D. A love poem

8. Where does Portia send Lucius?

A. To the Senate house

B. To Cassius's home

C. To Antony

D. To the market

9. Who strikes Caesar first?

A. Casca

B. Brutus

C. Cassius

D. Cinna

10. Does Brutus speak to the crowd in prose or verse?

A. Prose

B. Verse

C. Latin

D. Song

11. Why does the mob attack Cinna the poet?

A. He praised Brutus

B. He shares a name with a conspirator

C. He stole from them

D. He insulted Caesar

12. What are the triumvirs doing at the start of the scene?

A. Planning Caesar's funeral

B. Marking names of men to be killed

C. Writing laws

D. Dividing the army

13. How does Lucilius say Cassius received him?

A. With great warmth

B. With open anger

C. With courtesy but not old friendliness

D. With tears

14. What does Brutus accuse Cassius of having?

A. A coward's tongue

B. A cold heart

C. An itching palm

D. A traitor's face

15. Where does the battle take place?
    A. Sardis
    B. Philippi
    C. Rome
    D. Actium
16. Whom does Brutus send with the orders?
    A. Titinius
    B. Messala
    C. Pindarus
    D. Lucilius
17. What does Pindarus mistakenly report?
    A. That Titinius has been captured
    B. That Brutus is dead
    C. That Rome is burning
    D. That Antony has fled
18. Who pretends to be Brutus?
    A. Messala
    B. Lucilius
    C. Titinius
    D. Cato
19. Who holds the sword for Brutus?
    A. Volumnius
    B. Clitus
    C. Strato
    D. Messala

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how power, ambition and tyranny develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.
2. Explain how honor and self-deception develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.
3. Explain how rhetoric and persuasion develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the play's central concerns (power, ambition and tyranny, honor and self-deception, rhetoric and persuasion, public versus private self, fate, omens and free will) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. C (Calpurnia and Portia); 2. C (To celebrate Caesar's triumph); 3. D (The ides of March); 4. A (It burned but was not scorched); 5. A (A serpent's egg); 6. A (It spouted blood that Romans bathed in); 7. B (The names of the conspirators); 8. A (To the Senate house); 9. A (Casca); 10. A (Prose); 11. B (He shares a name with a conspirator); 12. B (Marking names of men to be killed); 13. C (With courtesy but not old friendliness); 14. C (An itching palm); 15. B (Philippi); 16. B (Messala); 17. A (That Titinius has been captured); 18. B (Lucilius); 19. C (Strato)

Essay assignments

Essay: Power, ambition and tyranny

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about power, ambition and tyranny. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops power, ambition and tyranny across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of power, ambition and tyranny. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of power, ambition and tyranny, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of power, ambition and tyranny in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four

scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Honor and self-deception

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about honor and self-deception. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops honor and self-deception across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of honor and self-deception. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of honor and self-deception, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of honor and self-deception in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Rhetoric and persuasion

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about rhetoric and persuasion. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops rhetoric and persuasion across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of rhetoric and persuasion. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of rhetoric and persuasion, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of rhetoric and persuasion in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Public versus private self

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about public versus private self. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops public versus private self in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops public versus private self across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of public versus private self. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of public versus private self in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of public versus private self, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of public versus private self in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on public versus private self in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on public versus private self in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about public versus private self in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on public versus private self in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Fate, omens and free will

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about fate, omens and free will. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops fate, omens and free will across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate, omens and free will. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate, omens and free will, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of fate, omens and free will in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Original Liber et Libri curriculum. Quotations from the public-domain text. Vocabulary definitions are modern and contextual (curated; based on Princeton WordNet 3.0). Word histories appear only where verified (Online Etymology Dictionary, 2026-10-20); other words are student look-ups. AP and Cambridge entries are our own summaries with links, not College Board or Cambridge text; ICC-WC and LeL IDs are Liber et Libri labels. Included with every curriculum purchase and with Classroom Pro.